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This setting draws on the *Star Wars* Expanded Universe — *Knights of the Old Republic*, *The Old Republic MMO*, and related media — adapted for original use. All Star Wars IP belongs to Lucasfilm/Disney. This is unofficial fan content for personal use.

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THE CONCORDAT ERA

This campaign takes place four thousand years before the Star Wars films. There is no Darth Vader, no Empire, no Rebellion, no Luke Skywalker. Those stories happen millennia from now.

You are playing in the Old Republic era, when thousands of Jedi walked the galaxy, when the Sith were a living empire rather than a legend, and when the Force was infrastructure that civilizations depended on. Two wars have torn that world apart. The government that emerged from the wreckage holds power through a fragile bargain between former enemies. Three factions contest the galaxy's future, and each one believes it is saving what remains.

This is a political setting. Your character needs opinions, loyalties, and debts. Exploration and personal drama happen inside a galaxy where governments are failing and every person has chosen a side or is being forced to choose one.

If you know *Knights of the Old Republic*, you will recognize names and places adapted for this setting. Chapter 4 explains the original games and where this world diverges from them. If you have never heard of KOTOR, you lose nothing. This book explains every term, faction, and event from scratch.

Bring a character who believes something strongly enough to act on it. The galaxy will test that belief.

HOW TO USE THIS BOOK

This book describes the Concordat Era as a reasonably informed person living in it would understand it. The history is what most educated citizens were taught. The faction descriptions reflect public knowledge and common opinion. Some of it is accurate. Some of it is propaganda that passes for truth. Some of it is contested, and the book will tell you when reasonable people disagree.

Hidden conspiracies, the true answer to what is killing the Force, and the secret plans of people who have kept their secrets belong to your GM. You will discover them in play.

If you know *Knights of the Old Republic*, read Chapter 4 for the full summary of the original games and how this setting diverges. The biggest shift: the Great Hyperspace War happened twelve years ago in this setting, transforming the Sith Empire's fall from ancient history into living trauma. Malak never fell to the dark side. Revan never had his memory wiped. The Mandalorian Wars ended through a political bargain, not a superweapon. Familiar names appear, but the choices went differently.

If you've never played KOTOR, you lose nothing. This book explains everything from scratch. Chapter 4 summarizes the games for context, but the setting stands on its own.

For character creation, go to Chapter 3 after reading this section. It gives you the questions your character needs to answer. Then read the faction chapters (8 through 13) to find where your character fits. Chapter 21 covers species and peoples.

For understanding the setting, read as much or as little as you want. Chapter 5 explains the Force. Chapter 6 covers the Force crisis. Chapter 7 provides the full history. Chapters 14 through 17 cover Jedi, Sith, and Mandalorian belief systems.

On the Fate system: this campaign uses Fate, but this book is not a Fate rulebook. The setting material is system-agnostic. If you understand who your character is, what they believe, and who they owe, the system will follow.

A NOTE ON CALENDARS

This book uses two dating systems. **BBY** (Before the Battle of Yavin) is the standard reference calendar used by Star Wars historians. The campaign takes place 3,952 years before that moment. Nobody in 3952 BBY has any knowledge of the Battle of Yavin. BBY appears as an orientation tool for readers who know the broader Star Wars timeline.

In-world, characters use the **Concordat Era calendar**. Events before the Concordat's signing use **BC** (Before Concordat): 9 BC at the Great Hyperspace War's end, counting down to 1 BC. Events after use **CE** (Concordat Era): 1 CE, 2 CE, and so on. The campaign begins in 4 CE.

The year contains **10 months of approximately 35 days each** (368 days total), numbered Month 1 through Month 10. Full dates read: *Day 14 of Month 6, 4 CE.*

The calendar is political. Using Concordat Era dating signals loyalty to Malak's government. The Remnant uses the old Republic Standard Calendar. The Neo-Mandalorians use their own reckoning based on Mandalore cycles. How a character dates a letter tells you who they answer to.

CHAPTER 2

THE GALAXY AT A GLANCE

The galaxy is a disk of hundreds of billions of star systems. Civilizations have occupied it for tens of thousands of years. Ships travel between stars through **hyperspace**, a faster-than-light dimension that compresses interstellar distances into journeys of days or weeks. The galaxy is organized in concentric rings: the wealthy **Core Worlds** (Coruscant, Alderaan, Corellia) at the center, the **Mid Rim** in the middle band, and the underdeveloped **Outer Rim** at the frontier. Beyond the Outer Rim lies the **Unknown Regions**, largely unexplored.

The **Galactic Republic** governed most of known space for thousands of years. It was a democratic federation: a Senate on Coruscant, elected representatives, trade agreements, shared infrastructure. It is now fractured.

The **Jedi Order** served the Republic as peacekeepers, diplomats, healers, and mediators. Jedi are Force-sensitive beings trained from childhood to perceive and manipulate the Force, an energy field generated by all living things. A trained Jedi can move objects through concentration, sense danger before it manifests, heal wounds, and read emotions. The Order maintained roughly ten thousand members at its peak. It is now broken into factions that disagree about everything.

The **Sith** are three things at once: a red-skinned Force-sensitive species native to the planet Korriban, the religious-political order that conquered them seven thousand years ago, and a philosophical tradition built on passion and power. The Sith Empire fought a war against the Republic twelve years ago and lost. Most people consider the Sith a defeated enemy. Most people are wrong.

The **Mandalorians** are a warrior culture organized around clans, honor codes, and combat. They are not a species but a creed: anyone who follows Mandalorian ways and earns acceptance can become Mandalorian. They waged a devastating war of expansion against the Republic that ended seven years ago.

The **Force** is real, measurable, and woven into the fabric of galactic civilization. Hospitals relied on Force-sensitive healers. Navigators used the Force to plot safer hyperspace routes. Governments employed Jedi as mediators and peacekeepers. Chapter 5 explains the Force in full. For now, know that it is failing, and nobody understands why.

Kolto is the galaxy's primary healing substance, produced on the ocean world Manaan alone. It accelerates cellular regeneration and treats trauma. With Force healing unreliable, kolto has become the most valuable substance in the galaxy.

RECENT HISTORY

Two wars broke the galaxy.

The Great Hyperspace War (3964 BBY, twelve years ago): The Sith Empire invaded the Republic. The war ended with the Empire's collapse, but the fighting left permanent scars in the Force itself. Dead zones appeared, places where the Force simply stopped working. The Sith as a political power were destroyed. The Sith as a species were scattered. The Sith as an idea survived.

The Mandalorian Wars (3963-3955 BBY): Mandalorian clans launched a campaign of conquest across the Outer and Mid Rim. The Jedi Council refused to intervene. Two Jedi, Revan and Malak, defied the Council, built a military from volunteers and defectors, and fought the Mandalorians for seven years. The war ended when Malak challenged Mandalore the Vindicated to single combat, won, and negotiated a political settlement called the Concordat. The cost of victory included twelve planets with permanent Force damage, approximately six hundred thousand civilian dead, and a Jedi Order that could no longer agree on what it stood for.

Now, the **Concordat** governs from Coruscant. Supreme Chancellor-General Malak, the Jedi general who won the war, leads a hybrid government merging Republic administration with Mandalorian military strength. The Concordat holds the Core Worlds and most of the Inner Rim. It provides stability, infrastructure, and a functional economy. It also monitors Force-sensitive citizens, appoints military governors, and maintains emergency powers with no expiration date. Malak wears prosthetics where his jaw and arm used to be, the price paid for beating Mandalore with iron rather than the Force.

The **Revanchist Remnant** holds twenty-three Outer Rim systems and claims to be the legitimate Republic. Its figurehead is Revan, the strategist who started the Jedi revolt against Council inaction. Revan spent two years in the Unknown Regions chasing ancient technology and returned diminished and obsessed. Admiral Kaeranth runs the Remnant's actual operations.

The **Neo-Mandalorian Coalition** answers to Canderous Ordo, a traditionalist who rejected the Concordat as a betrayal of warrior honor. The Coalition holds no fixed territory. It raids from hidden bases across the Outer Rim and Wild Space.

None of these governments commands universal loyalty. Citizens across hundreds of worlds make daily choices about which authority to obey, which to resist, and which to ignore.

THE FORCE IS DYING

Something is wrong with the Force. Jedi healers find their abilities fail without warning. Seers report fragmented visions and stretches of silence. Combat-trained Jedi feel their precognition stutter mid-fight.

Dead zones mark places where the Force has gone absent. In a dead zone, a lightsaber still cuts (it is a plasma weapon, powered by a crystal), but every other Force ability fails. Species like the Miraluka, who perceive the world through the Force rather than through eyes, go blind. The zones are growing.

Hyperspace has become unreliable. Ships drop out days early. Some don't drop out at all.

A GALAXY IN TRANSITION

The Concordat Era is not a post-apocalyptic setting. The holonet (the galaxy-wide communication network) still functions. Freighters carry cargo. Cantinas serve drinks. But governance is fragile, supply chains are unreliable, and the Force can no longer be trusted.

CHAPTER 3
CREATING A CHARACTER

Character creation starts with six questions. Each one shapes who your character is and how they connect to the galaxy. Read the question, pick the answer that interests you, and move on. You can change your mind later. Nothing is permanent until the first session starts.

WHERE ARE YOU FROM?

Your homeworld determines what your character considers normal. Someone raised on Coruscant grew up surrounded by government offices, military patrols, and the assumption that the Concordat keeps the galaxy running. Someone raised on the Outer Rim grew up fixing their own equipment, settling disputes without authorities, and treating central government as a rumor. These assumptions shape how your character reacts when the campaign puts them in unfamiliar territory.

- "I grew up on Coruscant. My family worked in Concordat civil administration. I thought the government was boring and functional until I started noticing what it hid."
- "I'm from a farming settlement on Dantooine. We saw a Jedi once when I was twelve. She healed a neighbor's broken leg and left before dinner. That's my entire experience with the Force."
- "I was born on Dxun. My clan trained me to fight from the time I could hold a blade. The Mandalorian Wars ended before I was old enough to serve, and I've spent my whole life preparing for a war that already happened."
- "I'm Sith Pureblood. I grew up on Nar Shaddaa pretending to be something else, because the galaxy treats my species like a threat."

WHAT DID YOU DO DURING THE WARS?

Two wars define this era. The Great Hyperspace War ended twelve years ago when the Sith Empire collapsed. The Mandalorian Wars ended six years ago when Malak killed Mandalore the Vindicated in single combat. If your character is old enough, they fought in one or both. If they are too young, the wars shaped the people who raised them.

- "I served in the Republic Navy during the Mandalorian Wars. I followed Revan because the Jedi Council refused to act. I saw what the Ashen Campaigns did to civilian populations, and I signed the next deployment order anyway."
- "I was a Jedi Padawan when the Council ordered us to stay neutral. I obeyed. Four hundred of my peers left to fight. Some came back changed. Some did not come back."
- "I was a child during the Great Hyperspace War. Sith soldiers occupied my homeworld for two years. I remember the sound of their ships leaving when the Empire fell."
- "I'm twenty-three. Both wars happened before I could hold a blaster. But my mother fought at Dxun and my father died at Malachor V, so the wars raised me whether I served or not."

WHO DO YOU WORK FOR?

Three governments compete for control of the galaxy. The Concordat runs the former Republic from Coruscant under Malak's authority. The Revanchist Remnant fights a guerrilla campaign for democratic restoration. The Neo-Mandalorian Coalition governs Mandalorian space through warrior tradition and honor codes. Your character works for one of them, works for none of them, or works for whoever pays.

- "I'm Concordat military intelligence. I believe in stability. The alternative is another war."
- "I run supplies for the Remnant. I don't love their politics, but they pay on time and they've never asked me to do something I couldn't sleep after."
- "I'm Neo-Mandalorian. I swore an oath to my clan and I honor it. Galaxy politics are someone else's problem until they become my clan's problem."
- "I'm freelance. I haul cargo. I don't ask what's in the crates and I don't care whose flag flies over the spaceport. I care about fuel costs and docking fees."

WHAT DO YOU BELIEVE ABOUT THE FORCE?

The Force is failing. Across the galaxy, zones have appeared where the Force stops working. Force-sensitive beings lose their abilities inside these dead zones. Entire planets have gone silent. Nobody knows why. Your character has an opinion about this, whether they can use the Force or not.

- "I'm a Jedi Knight. The Force has been the foundation of my life since I was four years old. Losing it, even for a moment inside a dead zone, feels like going deaf. I need to understand what's happening before it takes everything."
- "I think the Force is a natural phenomenon, like gravity. It fluctuates. People who built their lives around it are panicking because they confused a tool for a divine right. I feel sorry for them, but I don't share their crisis."
- "I'm not Force-sensitive. I never was. But my sister is, and watching her lose her abilities piece by piece is destroying her. The Force crisis is personal for me because it's personal for someone I love."
- "Good riddance. The Force gave the Jedi and the Sith power over everyone else for thousands of years. If it dies, maybe ordinary people get to run the galaxy for once."

WHAT DO YOU OWE?

Debts keep characters anchored to the world. A debt can be financial, emotional, or moral. Someone saved your character's life. Someone destroyed something your character loved. Someone is waiting for your character to come home. Political factions are abstractions. Debts are specific.

- "A Mandalorian pulled me out of a burning transport during the evacuation of Serroco. I never learned her name. I've been looking for her for six years."
- "I owe the Jedi Order my training, my discipline, my sense of purpose. The Order also lied to me about what happened at Malachor V. I haven't decided which of those facts matters more."

WHAT ARE YOU AFRAID OF?

Not physical danger. What threatens your character's sense of who they are? The answer to this question generates your character's best moments at the table, the scenes where they face the thing they've been avoiding.

- "I'm afraid the Concordat is right. That authoritarian stability is the only thing standing between the galaxy and collapse. I joined the Remnant because I believed in democracy, and I'm terrified that belief is naive."
- "I'm afraid I'll use the Force in anger and discover I'm good at it. Every Jedi fears the dark side in theory. I fear it because I've felt it respond to me."
- "I'm afraid of being ordinary. My whole life I've been the best pilot in every room. The Force crisis is producing people with nothing to lose and skills I can't match. I don't know who I am if I'm not the best."

ARCHETYPES

Several archetypes appear in Concordat Era campaigns. These are starting points, not limits.

The Veteran. Fought in the wars. Carries the experience in body and choices. A veteran knows what violence costs. The question that follows them: was it worth it?

The Operative. Works for a faction's intelligence apparatus. The Concordat Era runs on information, stolen transmissions, compromised agents, encrypted data. An operative lives in the gap between what factions say and what they do.

The Exile. Left something behind. A former Jedi who walked away from the Order. A Mandalorian who broke an oath. A Concordat officer who deserted. The exile carries two questions: what drove them out, and what would bring them back?

The Believer. Holds convictions strong enough to act on. The Concordat Era tests every belief system. A Jedi who believes in the Code. A Sith traditionalist who believes in the old ways. A democratic idealist fighting for the Remnant. The campaign asks: what happens to conviction when reality stops cooperating?

The Survivor. Chose no side. The galaxy's political drama is someone else's problem, until it shows up in the cargo hold. Survivors tend to develop opinions fast once the campaign forces them into situations where neutrality stops being an option.

The Inheritor. Too young to have fought. Old enough to inherit the consequences. The wars made the world they live in. They had no say in it. What they do next is the first choice that belongs to them.

A journalist. The HoloNet still functions. Someone reports on the Concordat's policies, the Remnant's guerrilla actions, the Force crisis. A journalist character moves through faction territory asking questions that make powerful people uncomfortable.

A doctor. Force healers are failing. Conventional medicine is picking up the slack. A trauma surgeon working the Outer Rim sees the human cost of every political decision. Medical skill is valuable to every faction, which means every faction wants your loyalty.

A mechanic. Ships break. Droids malfunction. Infrastructure decays. A skilled mechanic is welcome on any crew and in any port. The galaxy runs on technology, and someone has to keep it running.

A Force-sensitive who never trained. Not every Force-sensitive person joined the Jedi or the Sith. Some grew up on planets where no recruiter visited. Some had families who refused to give them up. An untrained Force-sensitive in the Concordat Era feels the crisis as a strange absence of something they never learned to name.

A Sith species scholar. The Sith as a species predate the Sith as a philosophy by thousands of years. A Sith Pureblood studying their own cultural heritage navigates a galaxy that conflates their identity with the Empire that enslaved their ancestors.

The campaign's opening scenarios (Chapter 22) put the party in a crisis that requires cooperation regardless of background. Whatever you bring to the table, the setting will give you something to push against.

BUILDING YOUR CHARACTER IN FATE

This campaign uses the **Fate Core** or **Fate Condensed** tabletop roleplaying system. If you have never played Fate before, here is what you need to know to build a character.

Fate characters are built from words, not numbers. Where other RPG systems define a character through statistics (Strength 16, Dexterity 14), Fate defines a character through short phrases called **aspects**. An aspect is a sentence fragment that describes something true about your character. Aspects can be invoked during play to gain bonuses when they're relevant, and they can be compelled to create complications when they'd make the story more interesting.

Every Fate character has three core aspects:

High concept. This is a Fate system term. Your high concept is a short phrase that captures the most important thing about your character: who they are, what they do, and what makes them distinct. A high concept should be specific enough that someone reading it can picture the character.

- "Disillusioned Concordat Intelligence Officer" tells you this person works for the government, gathers secrets, and has started questioning what they serve.
- "Mandalorian Combat Medic Who Broke Her Oath" tells you this person heals, fights, comes from warrior culture, and carries a specific failure.
- "Jedi Sentinel Hunting Dead Zones" tells you this person is an active Jedi with a mission tied to the Force crisis.
- "Skilled Spy" tells you almost nothing. Too vague. Push further.

Trouble. Your trouble is the aspect that makes your character's life difficult. The best troubles connect to the setting's conflicts and create situations your character cannot avoid.

- "My Unit Committed War Crimes at Onderon" connects to the Mandalorian Wars and produces guilt, loyalty conflicts, and the threat of exposure.
- "The Force Answers When I'm Angry" connects to the light/dark tension and means every fight risks pulling your character toward something dangerous.
- "Has Enemies" could mean anything. Too generic. Name the enemy. Name the reason.

Relationship aspect. This aspect connects your character to another player character. You build this one at the table during Session Zero, after everyone has their high concept and trouble. The best relationship aspects contain a seed of tension: a shared history, a debt, an unresolved conflict, or a bond complicated by faction loyalty.

- "She Pulled Me Out of the Wreck at Onderon" means you owe someone your life. What they ask of you now may cost more than the life they saved.
- "We Served in the Same Unit Before I Defected" means trust survived a betrayal. The question is how much trust remains.
- "Her Clan Destroyed My Homeworld and She Knows It" means the Mandalorian and the Cathar sit with the weight of history between them at every meal.

Free aspects (two). Your remaining two aspects round out the character. Use them for a skill or reputation, a possession that matters, a belief that drives action, or a connection outside the party.

- "The Datacron Revan Brought Back From Lehon" is an object with secrets. Everyone wants it. You have it. Why?
- "Strength Is Forged, Not Given" is the Doctrine of Necessary Strength as personal creed. It creates trouble when self-reliance meets a situation where you need help.
- "I Still Wear the Robes but I Stopped Praying" is a Jedi identity in crisis. The uniform stays. The faith is gone.

In this campaign, the word **tensions** refers to the setting's major unresolved conflicts: the political struggle between the Concordat, the Remnant, and the Coalition; the Force crisis and the dead zones spreading across the galaxy; the question of what Revan found in the Unknown Regions; the philosophical disagreements between Jedi and Sith about the nature of the Force. Your aspects should connect your character to at least one of these tensions. A character who cares about none of the galaxy's problems will struggle to find their place in the story.

SKILLS

Fate characters have **skills**: rated abilities that determine what your character is good at. The Concordat Era uses nineteen skills arranged in a pyramid:

- 1 skill at Great (+4)
- 2 skills at Good (+3)
- 3 skills at Fair (+2)
- 4 skills at Average (+1)
- Everything else at Mediocre (+0)

Your Great (+4) skill is what your character does better than almost anyone. Your pyramid's shape tells the table who you are before you describe a single scene.

The full skill list: **Academics** (formal education, institutional knowledge), **Athletics** (running, dodging, zero-gravity maneuvering), **Burglary** (breaking in, slicing systems, bypassing locks), **Contacts** (knowing people, calling in favors), **Crafts** (building, repairing, jury-rigging), **Deceive** (lying, disguise, forged documents), **Drive** (piloting starships, speeders, anything with a throttle), **Empathy** (reading people, detecting lies), **Fight** (melee combat, lightsabers, vibroblades), **Investigate** (methodical examination, piecing together evidence), **Lore** (obscure knowledge, Force traditions, Sith archaeology), **Notice** (immediate perception, spotting danger), **Physique** (strength, endurance, toughness), **Provoke** (intimidation, goading, emotional pressure), **Rapport** (building trust, persuasion, diplomacy), **Resources** (wealth, requisition authority), **Shoot** (ranged combat, blasters), **Stealth** (moving unseen, electronic countermeasures), **Will** (mental fortitude, resistance to pressure).

Two skills deserve special attention. **Academics** covers what universities teach: history, law, medicine, political science. **Lore** covers what universities do not know: Sith archaeology, dead-zone phenomena, Rakatan ruins, kolto biochemistry, frontier survival wisdom. A Republic-trained doctor has Academics. A Korriban tomb crawler has Lore. Some characters have both.

STUNTS

Stunts are special tricks or talents that let your character break the normal rules in specific ways. You start with three free stunts (two if you take the Force-Sensitive Extra). Each stunt follows one of two templates:

Template A: "Because I [something exceptional about you], I get +2 when I use [skill] to [action] when [specific circumstance]."

- "Because I trained in traditional Mandalorian saber combat, I get +2 when I use Fight to defend against lightsaber-wielding opponents."
- "Because I've spent years reading signals intelligence, I get +2 when I use Investigate to create advantages by analyzing intercepted communications."
- "Because I carry legitimate Concordat authorization, I get +2 when I use Rapport to overcome bureaucratic obstacles in Concordat territory."

Template B: "Because I [something exceptional about you], once per session I can [special effect] instead of [what you'd normally do]."

- "Because I understand fire discipline, once per session I can use Shoot to create the advantage **Pinned Down** on every enemy in a zone with a single roll."
- "Because I've run Remnant supply lines for three years, once per session I can automatically succeed on a Drive roll to escape pursuit in a system where I've established a hidden route."

Build stunts that reflect your character's history. A stunt is a story compressed into a mechanical bonus.

FORCE-SENSITIVE CHARACTERS: THE MECHANICAL TRADE-OFF

The Force in this campaign functions as an **extra**: a bundle of permissions and costs that changes how your character interacts with the world. If you want to play a Force-sensitive character, here is what it costs and what it gives you.

Cost: One of your three stunt slots goes to the Force-Sensitive Extra (you get two free stunts instead of three). Your trouble aspect must involve the Force crisis in some way.

Benefit: You choose two **Force techniques** from the list below. Each technique lets you use an existing skill in an expanded way. You can purchase additional techniques as stunts.

The available techniques: **Telekinesis** (use Physique to move objects at distance), **Precognition** (use Notice to sense danger before it arrives), **Force Healing** (use Academics to accelerate recovery), **Battle Meditation** (use Rapport to coordinate allies in combat), **Force Empathy** (use Empathy to perceive emotional states at supernatural depth), **Force Concealment** (use Stealth to suppress your Force presence), **Lightsaber Mastery** (use Fight to deflect blaster bolts and perform Force-enhanced combat), **Force Persuasion** (use Provoke or Rapport to influence weak-willed targets).

The catch: Force Instability. The GM has a standing compel against your Force-related aspects whenever you use a Force technique. The Force fails roughly one-third of the time in normal space, two-thirds of the time near dead zones, and requires a fate point to attempt at all inside dead zones. When the compel fires, you take a fate point and find a non-Force solution. When you buy off the compel with a fate point, the Force works.

This creates a specific economy. Force-sensitive characters earn fate points faster (they get compelled more often) but spend them to guarantee their abilities work. Non-Force characters earn fate points through other compels and spend them on different advantages. The party's economy balances itself.

Miraluka characters deserve a special note. Miraluka perceive the world through the Force. For a Miraluka, Force instability means temporary blindness: the character loses their primary sense. This is harsh. It is also accurate to the setting. As compensation, Miraluka characters receive the **Force Empathy** technique for free (in addition to their two chosen techniques), because Force perception is their baseline existence. Playing a Miraluka means accepting moments of terrifying vulnerability in exchange for a richer baseline awareness than any other species possesses.

STRESS, CONSEQUENCES, AND FATE POINTS

Every character has **stress boxes** (your ability to absorb hits before taking real harm) and **consequences** (lasting injuries or setbacks that stick around after the fight). Physique determines your physical stress capacity. Will determines your mental stress capacity.

Consequences come in three severities: **mild** (a bruise, a shaken nerve), **moderate** (a blaster wound, broken trust), and **severe** (a crushed leg, a severed Force connection). Severe consequences alter your character's story. In the Concordat Era, Force-related consequences heal slower than physical ones, because the Force itself is unreliable.

Kolto treatment accelerates physical recovery. A character with medical training (Academics) who applies kolto can begin clearing a physical consequence one step faster than normal. A mild consequence clears immediately. A moderate consequence starts clearing after one scene instead of one session. Kolto availability depends on where you are: affordable in the Core Worlds, expensive in contested space, scarce on the frontier, and absent in ungoverned territory unless you packed it yourself. Chapter 19 covers kolto economics, supply chains, and the counterfeit market in detail.

Fate points are your currency for influencing the story. You start each session with a **Refresh** of 3 (reduced by 1 for each stunt beyond your free allotment, minimum 1). You earn fate points when the GM compels your aspects, and you spend them to invoke aspects for bonuses or to buy off compels you do not want. The Concordat Era generates compels constantly. Political tensions, overlapping loyalties, Force instability, and troubled histories built into your aspects mean you will earn 2-4 fate points per session and spend them freely. The economy flows. Do not hoard.

Your GM will walk you through the full mechanical details during character creation. The Fate Condensed Player Guide for this setting covers skills, techniques, stunts, and dead zone rules in complete detail. For now, focus on the questions, the aspects, and the concept. The numbers come last.

PRE-BUILT EXAMPLES

These two characters demonstrate how the same process produces different people. One relies on the Force. One does not. Both belong in this campaign.

Kael Shelaari, Jedi Sentinel

Where are you from? The Jedi Enclave on Dantooine. Kael entered the Order at age five and trained under Master Vandar until the Mandalorian Wars.

What did you do during the wars? Kael followed Revan. He served as a forward scout, using Force perception to map Mandalorian positions ahead of Republic advances. He witnessed three Ashen Campaign strikes and carries that knowledge in silence.

Who do you work for? Officially, the Jedi Council. In practice, Kael operates alone. The Council assigned him to investigate dead zones, and he has spent two years mapping their spread across the Outer Rim.

What do you believe about the Force? Kael believes the Force is wounded. He feels it the way a doctor feels a patient's fever. Something is wrong at a level deeper than politics or philosophy, and if nobody identifies the cause, the patient dies.

What do you owe? Kael watched a Padawan named Sila die during a dead zone event on Katarr. The Force vanished. His healing abilities cut out. She bled to death while he held pressure with his hands. He owes her an answer to what happened.

What are you afraid of? That the Force is dying because of something Revan did in the Unknown Regions. That the investigation Kael has devoted two years to will lead him to a truth the Jedi Council does not want found.

High concept: "Jedi Sentinel Mapping the Force's Wounds" **Trouble:** "I Watched a Padawan Die Because My Healing Failed" **Relationship aspect:** (built at Session Zero with another PC) **Free aspects:** "The Council Sent Me to Find Answers, Not Ask Questions" / "Two Years Alone in Dead Space Changes a Person"

Skills: Investigate at Great (+4). Lore and Notice at Good (+3). Athletics, Will, and Fight at Fair (+2). Academics, Stealth, Empathy, and Drive at Average (+1).

Force-Sensitive Extra: Kael chose **Precognition** (Notice) and **Force Healing** (Academics) as his two Force techniques. His trouble ties to the Force crisis as required.

Stunts (2 free): "Because I've mapped dead zones for two years, I get +2 when I use Investigate to overcome challenges related to dead zone phenomena." / "Because the Force trained my reflexes before it failed me, I get +2 when I use Fight to defend in melee when I can sense my opponent through the Force."

Refresh: 3

Voss Caldean , Freelance Pilot

Where are you from? Nar Shaddaa. Voss grew up in the refugee quarter after her family fled the Great Hyperspace War. She learned to fly stolen speeders before she learned to read.

What did you do during the wars? Voss ran blockade cargo during the Mandalorian Wars. She never enlisted. She flew medical supplies to besieged planets because the Remnant paid triple rates for pilots willing to dodge Concordat patrols.

Who do you work for? Whoever pays. Voss owns a modified YT-1000 freighter called the *Rust Hymn*. She takes contracts from Remnant sympathizers, Concordat shipping firms, independent traders. Loyalty to a faction means loyalty to their problems. She prefers her own.

What do you believe about the Force? Voss is not Force-sensitive. She has watched Force users move objects with their minds, predict danger before it arrives, and heal wounds that should have killed. She respects the ability the way she respects a good hyperdrive: useful, impressive, and not something she depends on. The Force crisis troubles her because the people losing their abilities are the same people the galaxy built its infrastructure around. When a Jedi healer fails, the hospital fails. When a Force-sensitive navigator goes dark, ships crash.

What do you owe? A Mandalorian named Torreck saved her life during a pirate ambush in the Hydian corridor. He refused payment. In Mandalorian culture, that means the debt stands until you repay it with something of equal weight. Voss has been looking for Torreck for three years. She suspects he is dead. She cannot stop looking.

What are you afraid of? That she will never own anything permanent. Every ship, every contract, every friendship exists on a timer. Nar Shaddaa taught her that anything you love can vanish between breakfast and lunch. She flies because movement is the only thing that feels stable. Stopping means confronting the fact that she has nowhere to stop.

High concept: "Nar Shaddaa Blockade Runner Who Owes a Dead Mandalorian" **Trouble:** "Loyalty Is a Luxury I Can't Afford" **Relationship aspect:** (built at Session Zero with another PC) **Free aspects:** "The Rust Hymn Is the Only Home That Hasn't Burned Down" / "I Know Every Smuggler's Route in the Mid Rim"

Skills: Drive at Great (+4). Shoot and Contacts at Good (+3). Crafts, Notice, and Stealth at Fair (+2). Deceive, Resources, Athletics, and Will at Average (+1).

Not Force-sensitive. Voss has no Force techniques. She gets three free stunts.

Stunts (3 free): "Because I've run Remnant supply lines for three years, once per session I can automatically succeed on a Drive roll to escape pursuit in a system where I've established a hidden route." / "Because I fix things with whatever's available, I get +2 when I use Crafts to overcome equipment failure with improvised materials." / "Because I know the underworld's channels, I get +2 when I use Contacts to acquire black-market goods or services in Exchange-controlled territory."

Refresh: 3

Both characters belong at the same table. Kael brings the Force and its crisis into every scene. Voss brings practical skills that never fail because the galaxy is having a spiritual emergency. When a dead zone hits, Kael loses his abilities and Voss keeps flying. When the Force reveals danger seconds before it arrives, Kael saves the crew and Voss recalibrates her respect for something she cannot touch. The campaign needs both.

For the GM Only: Why the Party Stays Together

The Concordat Era's political fractures mean party members may come from opposing factions. A Concordat officer, a Remnant sympathizer, a Neo-Mandalorian warrior, and a Jedi Sentinel have no institutional reason to cooperate.

Parties stay together for the same reason people in crisis form crews: necessity, shared survival, and the bonds that form when you depend on each other under pressure. The Freighter Incident (Chapter 22) establishes these bonds. By the time the party escapes their first crisis, they have saved each other's lives, shared information that makes them liabilities to their respective factions, and discovered that the person across the table is more complicated than the uniform suggested.

The campaign will test party cohesion. Let it. Characters who disagree about politics but trust each other in combat produce better stories than characters who agree about everything.

CHAPTER 4

THE GAMES THAT CAME BEFORE

This setting builds on two video games: *Star Wars: Knights of the Old Republic* (2003) and *Star Wars: Knights of the Old Republic II: The Sith Lords* (2004). You do not need to have played them. This chapter summarizes their stories so you understand the raw material this setting rearranges.

KNIGHTS OF THE OLD REPUBLIC

Revan was a prodigal Jedi Knight eager to fight in the Mandalorian Wars. The Jedi Council forbade it. Revan fought anyway. When the wars ended and victory came, Revan and his closest ally Malak ventured into the Unknown Regions seeking ancient Rakatan technology. They found the Star Forge, a factory station capable of producing warships without end. The dark side waited there. Both men fell.

They returned as Sith Lords and launched the Jedi Civil War against the Republic they had saved. Republic worlds burned. The Jedi Order collapsed fighting for survival.

The Jedi captured Revan during a raid on Malak's flagship. Instead of killing him, they used the Force to wipe his memory clean and implant a false, generic upbringing that leads to enlistment in the Republic.

Revan woke aboard the **Endar Spire**, a Republic ship during a sick attack. After boarding an escape pod and crashing on the nearby planet of Taris, Revan escapes the Sith blockade and system-wide manhunt with a Republic soldier named Carth Onasi, a Twi'lek named Mission Vao, and the wookie Zaalbarr.

From this point, the amnesiac soldier gathered companions. Bastila Shan, a Jedi with the rare gift of Battle Meditation, the ability to coordinate entire fleets through the Force. Canderous Ordo, the last of the great Mandalorian commanders, a warrior without a cause. Jolee Bindo, an old Jedi who had walked away from the Order and chosen isolation in the Kashyyyk forests. Juhani, a Cathar Jedi seeking redemption for her own dark deeds. HK-47, an assassination droid who spoke of murder as philosophy.

The party pursued Star Maps across five worlds. Dantooine, Kashyyyk, Manaan, Tatooine, Korriban. Each map pointed toward the Star Forge and toward Malak, who ruled as sole Dark Lord of the Sith.

The journey broke Revan's amnesia. Bastila revealed the truth: the player was Revan, former Sith Lord, mind-wiped and conscripted by the Jedi Council. Revan confronted Malak at the Star Forge itself. The former apprentice had grown drunk on power, sustained by the station's production. Revan defeated him. The Star Forge burned.

The game's central question: What defines the self? The Sith Lord who fell and the amnesiac soldier redeemed by friends were the same body, different lives. The player's choices, turn by turn, planet by planet, provided the answer.

THE SITH LORDS

The second game asked a harder question: what if the Force itself was the problem?

The player is the Jedi Exile, a former Jedi who followed Revan to the Mandalorian Wars, achieving the rank of General. At the war's final battle above Malachor V, the Exile activated a superweapon that killed thousands on both sides. The mass death should have destroyed the Exile through the Force, the way every death in the blast radius rippled through the web of living connections. Instead, the Exile's mind did something unprecedented: it severed its own connection to the Force as a survival mechanism.

The Exile became a wound in the Force. A void. Someone who unconsciously formed bonds with the people around them and drained their connection to the Force without knowing it.

Kreia was the game's central figure. An old woman who served as the Exile's mentor, she was also Darth Traya, former Jedi Master of Revan and former Sith Lord, who had concluded that the Force itself was the enemy of all living things. The Force moved beings like pieces on a board, she argued. It elevated those it favored and crushed those it discarded. Both Jedi and Sith served the same master without knowing it. Kreia wanted to kill the Force itself.

The Sith Triumvirate hunted the last Jedi. Darth Nihilus consumed the Force from living things, draining entire planets and leaving husks. He destroyed Katarr, killing an entire Miraluka colony. Darth Sion refused to die, held together by pain and the dark side, a man made of broken bones and fury. Darth Traya orchestrated from the shadows.

The game offered no clean redemption. The Exile could not be made whole again. The wound in the Force persisted. Kreia's philosophy was seductive and terrible: what if detachment and passion were both traps? What if the Force was parasitic? What if salvation meant destroying the thing every civilization in the galaxy had built itself around?

These questions haunt this setting. They are the philosophical foundation the Concordat Era builds on.

HOW THIS SETTING DIVERGES

The games told their stories. This setting picks up the pieces and rearranges them.

The Great Hyperspace War moved forward by roughly a thousand years. In canon, the war between the Sith Empire and the Republic (Naga Sadow's invasion) occurred around 5000 BBY, a millennium before the events of KOTOR. In this setting, the war ended in 3964 BBY, twelve years before the campaign starts. The Sith Empire's collapse is living memory. Veterans of that war walk the streets. Orphans of that war are young adults. This single change makes the Sith a present wound rather than a historical footnote, and connects the Force crisis to events that characters can remember.

Malak never fell to the dark side. In the games, Malak became Darth Malak, a Sith Lord who waged war on the Republic. Here, he remained a Jedi general who ended the Mandalorian Wars through single combat and political negotiation, then became the Concordat's Supreme Chancellor-General. His moral complexity comes from authoritarianism, not Sith corruption.

Revan was never captured or mind-wiped. In KOTOR, the Jedi Council captured Revan and erased his memories. Here, Revan left for the Unknown Regions voluntarily, chasing Rakatan technology, and returned diminished and obsessed.

His story is about intellectual ambition consuming a brilliant mind, not about identity and redemption.

The Mandalorian Wars ended through the Concordat, not the Star Forge. In the games, the wars ended when Revan seized the Star Forge and turned it against the Mandalorians. Here, Malak challenged Mandalore to single combat, won, and forged a political alliance. The Star Forge may or may not exist. Its status is a campaign mystery.

The Jedi Civil War never happened. In canon, Revan and Malak turned on the Republic after the Mandalorian Wars. That war does not occur in this setting. Instead, the galaxy fractured into three competing governments, each led by people who believe they're doing the right thing.

CHAPTER 5

WHAT IS THE FORCE?

The Force is an energy field generated by all living things. It binds the galaxy together. In this setting, treat it as a real, measurable phenomenon, closer to gravity or magnetism than to mysticism.

Force-sensitive beings perceive and manipulate this field. A trained user can move objects through concentration, sense danger before it manifests, heal wounds, read emotions in others, communicate across light-years, or accelerate their own reflexes beyond baseline human limits. These abilities are learnable skills, not miracles. A Force-sensitive child who trains for ten years becomes more capable than one trained for two.

Scholars and Force traditions have debated for millennia whether the Force has moral dimensions. They call these the light side, associated with calm, selflessness, harmony with other living things, and the dark side, associated with passion, aggression, dominion over others. Whether these categories describe objective forces in the galaxy or reflect how different users relate to the same phenomenon remains one of the oldest arguments among Force users themselves. Chapter 14 and Chapter 15 explore the Jedi and Sith positions on this question in depth.

THE FORCE IN THIS ERA

The Force works the same way in your setting as in any other Star Wars era. What differs is abundance, integration, diversity, and reliability.

Abundance. In the movie era, the time of Luke Skywalker and Darth Vader, Force users number fewer than a handful across the entire galaxy. Entire star systems never encounter one. In your era, Force users number in the tens of thousands. The Jedi Order, at its pre-war peak, maintained approximately ten thousand Knights and Masters. The Sith Empire fielded several thousand sorcerers and Force-capable soldiers. Dozens of smaller traditions operated independently.

Integration into society. Force users in this era served functions that were critical and ordinary. A Jedi healer staffed a hospital on Coruscant, treating trauma and disease. A Force-sensitive navigator on a merchant vessel predicted hyperspace anomalies and plotted safer courses. A Sith engineer enhanced manufacturing through telekinetic precision. Baran Do Sages on Dorin predicted weather patterns through the Force. Selkath shamans on Manaan served as judges and counselors. The Force was infrastructure. Citizens relied on it. Planets built economies around Force-user labor. This dependence created fragility. When Force users began failing in their duties, the systems designed around their presence began failing too.

Diversity of traditions. The Jedi and Sith were the two largest organized traditions, but they were never the only options. The Order of Shasa on Manaan, the Baran Do Sages of Dorin, Mandalorian Force-skeptics, village shamans on a hundred Outer Rim worlds. These traditions disagreed on methodology, philosophy, and the proper use of Force abilities. A Force-sensitive being born in this era could receive training from many teachers, or from none.

Individual power versus coordination. No Force user in this era lifts a Star Destroyer with their mind. No single Knight deflects the fire of a hundred soldiers at once. Power comes through training, discipline, and coordination. A strike team of five Jedi with complementary abilities could hold a fortified position against a battalion. A medical team of Force-sensitive healers could triage casualties faster than conventional medicine. The Ashen Campaigns demonstrated what hundreds of coordinated Force users could accomplish: strikes that shattered orbital platforms and killed jungles. They also demonstrated the price. Thousands dead. Twelve planets scarred. The Force itself damaged by its own weaponization. Individual Force users were dangerous. Organized groups were devastating. Neither was invincible.

The Force is failing. This is the crisis that defines your era. Abilities that worked reliably a decade ago now stutter, fail, or vanish in dead zones. Precognition cuts out mid-fight. Healing fails mid-surgery. Long-range Force communication goes silent for days. Force users wake each morning uncertain whether their abilities will function. Chapter 6 covers the crisis in full detail.

FORCE SENSITIVITY

Force sensitivity exists on a spectrum. A mildly Force-sensitive farmer might have good instincts about weather and crop health, slightly better than baseline human perception, enough to improve harvests. She might never receive formal training. She might not know the Force is the source of her luck.

A trained Jedi Knight can deflect blaster bolts, sense danger before it arrives, and move heavy objects through will. Her training took a decade or more.

Between these poles exist countless gradations: a scout with sharper instincts, a merchant with unusual empathy, a soldier with reflexes that edge into the superhuman.

Approximately one in ten thousand beings across the galaxy possess Force sensitivity to a degree that allows meaningful training. Some species, Miraluka and Sith Purebloods in particular, show higher rates. Most baseline humans show lower rates.

In this era, the Concordat government registers Force-sensitive citizens. The Jedi Order trains them, or used to. The Sith Empire conscripted them. Now, with all three institutions in various states of fracture, a Force-sensitive person born on the frontier might live their entire life without formal training, or without knowing what they are.

If you play a Force-sensitive character: your abilities are unreliable. Build a character who can function when the Force fails. Carry a blaster. Learn medicine. Know how to fly without precognition.

If you play a non-Force-sensitive character: the Force crisis affects you anyway. Medicine costs more because Force healing covers less. Travel takes longer because hyperspace routes degrade near dead zones. Infrastructure decays because the specialists who maintained it through the Force can no longer deliver.

Dead zones are regions where the Force is absent. In a dead zone, a lightsaber still cuts (it is a plasma blade powered by a crystal battery). Every other Force ability fails. Precognition, telekinesis, healing, empathy: gone. A Force user in a dead zone is a person with a glowing sword and no other advantages.

THE LIGHT AND DARK SIDES

The Force contains multitudes, and philosophers of the Force disagree on whether those multitudes carry moral weight. Six major traditions have emerged from this disagreement, each claiming to describe reality more accurately than the others.

Jedi Orthodox Position. The light side represents the Force's natural state, a pattern of balance and unity that underlies all existence. The dark side emerges when Force users corrupt this pattern through selfish application, when they demand power for themselves rather than aligning with what the Force offers. Meditation, selflessness, and emotional discipline attune a user to this natural state. Passion, aggression, and the hunger for personal dominion distort the connection, introducing noise into a signal meant to be clear. The Jedi Council teaches this distinction as the foundation of their Order's survival. A Force user who embraces the dark side fractures the harmony that sustains them, and that fracture spreads outward to crack the galaxy around them.

The Orthodox position carries weight because it offers a coherent ethical system tied to metaphysics. If the Force has a natural state and a corrupted state, then choosing correctly has cosmic significance. The Jedi Order's thousand-year history of relative stability appears to validate this claim. The position requires faith in an invisible natural order that outsiders cannot verify.

Sith Imperial Position. The dark side is the Force's true nature, and the light side is a cage constructed by cowards who feared their own power. Passion, ambition, and the will to dominate reveal truth about how the Force operates. A being who acknowledges their desire for power and acts on it achieves harmony with reality. Conflict and struggle are the engine of growth and transformation. The Sith Empire encoded this understanding in its training academies and military doctrine. A Force user who embraces this path stops lying to themselves and becomes capable of reshaping civilizations.

This position also offers internal consistency. If the Force rewards the strong and punishes the weak, then seeking strength is rational. The Sith Empire's military achievements and technological innovations suggest that something worked. The Empire's repeated collapse raises uncomfortable questions about whether truth and strategy are the same thing, or whether they part ways at critical moments.

Keeper of Adas Position. The Force has no sides. The Jedi and the Exile-era Sith imposed "light" and "dark" as categories onto a phenomenon older than both traditions by millennia. Before the Jedi Order existed, the pre-Exile Sith engaged the Force through passion, rage, and transformation without conceiving of their work as "dark." They felt no need to justify their emotions as corruption. Rage at injustice and joy at creation both served the pattern. The categories "light" and "dark" are metaphors that have calcified into supposed realities. Believers defend these metaphors with theological arguments, but the metaphors shape the arguments, creating a circle of confirmation.

Keepers point to evidence that Force users who operate outside the Jedi or Sith frameworks achieve stability and sophistication without sorting emotions into moral bins. The Keepers struggle to explain why the light/dark binary exerts such a powerful pull on Force users regardless of training tradition or cultural background.

Secular/Mandalorian Position. The Force is a natural phenomenon with no moral dimension. Calling it "light" or "dark" resembles calling gravity "good" or "evil," a category error committed by beings who need the universe to validate their choices. Force users project their own ethics onto an energy field, then claim the energy field's structure endorses their ethics. This reasoning is circular and unconvincing. The field amplifies intention and energy. Whether the user's intention is generous or ruthless, the field responds without judgment. The Mandalorian warrior tradition engages the Force through technique and presence rather than moral aspiration, and achieves remarkable results without importing theological baggage.

This position has appeal because it avoids unfalsifiable claims. It fails to account for why Force users across traditions report that certain emotional and behavioral patterns produce more coherent results than others. If the Force had no bias, these patterns would be subjective preferences rather than stable patterns of success and failure.

Kreia's Nihilism. Both the light side and the dark side are traps. The Force itself functions as a cosmic prison, binding the galaxy to a deterministic pattern, puppeting civilizations toward outcomes that serve the Force's own continuity rather than the beings who inhabit the galaxy. Freedom means breaking free of the Force entirely. Kreia developed this philosophy across decades of study and taught it to a small circle of students. Most are dead. Few take her work seriously because she offers no path to power, only the promise of liberation at the cost of disconnection from everything that makes a Force user formidable. Her students report experiences that no other tradition produces: a quality of awareness that suggests they have touched something real.

Kreia's position gains strength from the observation that both Jedi and Sith seek permanence through their philosophies, trying to establish stable orders that perpetuate themselves. Both traditions mistake the Force's nature for a recipe for immortality. Both fail. Accepting Kreia's conclusion requires abandoning the very tool most Force users value most.

The Wound Perspective. The Force crisis created this position. In dead zones, neither the light side nor the dark side has influence. Beings who have lived through dead zone exposure report a clarity of mind they describe as neither light nor dark, neither distorted nor aligned. Some seek this state through ritual or meditation, trying to approximate a dead zone's silence without leaving populated space. Others fear it as spiritual death, a severing of the connection that makes them powerful or whole. The Wound Perspective has emerged among a coalition of philosophers, mystics, and soldiers who survived dead zone events and now ask whether the Force's absence might be more truthful than its presence.

This position lacks the historical weight of Orthodox or Imperial doctrine, but it addresses a crisis that the older traditions did not anticipate. If the Force can vanish, then neither side's claim to represent ultimate reality holds absolute weight.

Your character's position on this question shapes how they relate to every Force user they meet. A Jedi who accepts Orthodox doctrine reads Revan's choices one way. A Mandalorian who embraces Secular philosophy reads those same choices differently. The six positions above represent genuine disagreements about reality. Your character knows which position resonates with their experience and which ones they find unconvincing, and they will defend that position when they encounter Force users committed to something else.

REVAN AND MALAK

These two individuals illustrate the light/dark question more concretely than any abstract philosophy can. Revan and Malak, the architects of the Revanchist movement and the Ashen Campaigns, defied the Jedi Council, studied Sith techniques, and led military operations that killed hundreds of thousands. Neither declares himself a Sith Lord, and the Jedi cannot agree on whether they fell or transcended.

Revan

Revan was a Jedi who defied the Council's order to stay neutral during the Mandalorian Wars. He believed the Council was wrong; that the galaxy would fall to Mandalorian invasion if the Jedi did not act. He departed the Order without permission and rallied Jedi and military forces to his cause. The Jedi Council characterized this as falling to the dark side through pride and disobedience. Revan characterized it as clarity.

Once committed to the war, Revan did what commanders do: he pursued advantage. He studied Sith holocrons to decode ritual techniques that could be weaponized. He decoded the Ashen Campaign methodology, a coordinated Force attack amplified through ritual channeling and applied across multiple strike points simultaneously. He transmitted the technique to Malak for execution while he pursued Rakatan technology. Over two years of campaigning, the Ashen Campaigns killed approximately 600,000 civilians and damaged twelve planets. Revan approved each strike.

Revan then departed for the Unknown Regions to chase legends of Rakatan technology. He was gone for two years. He returned diminished, obsessed, speaking in fragments, switching between lucidity and incoherence. He has never declared himself a Sith Lord. He has never adopted the Sith Code or its philosophy. He carries crates of datacrons and speaks about "the pattern beneath the Force" with the intensity of a prophet and the specificity of a fever dream.

The Jedi Council reads Revan as a cautionary tale: a brilliant strategist who touched forbidden knowledge and lost himself. The Revanchist Remnant reads him as a visionary who was right about the Mandalorian threat when the Council was wrong. The Concordat views him as a security threat. The Mandalorians respect his strategic mind but note that he left the war before it ended and let Malak do the hard work. Chapter 7 covers the Council's historical account. Chapter 9 covers the Remnant's interpretation. Chapter 8 covers the Concordat's position.

Did Revan fall to the dark side, or did he embrace the Keeper of Adas position, that emotional engagement and aggressive strategy are not inherently corrupting?

His diminishment upon return suggests something happened in the Unknown Regions. What he found and what it did to him are questions Revan cannot answer clearly. Your character will form their own opinion.

Malak

Malak was Revan's operational counterpart: the general who managed logistics, troop movements, and the brutal mathematics of attrition warfare. He authorized each of the forty-one Ashen Campaign strikes, coordinating ritual technique, strike timing, and force distribution. He used Sith-derived channeling methods that Revan decoded from a holocron. He bears direct responsibility for the casualties and planetary damage those campaigns produced. He read the damage reports. He signed the next order.

Malak refused to adopt the Sith identity his techniques suggested. He challenged Mandalore the Vindicated to single combat, a test of honor in Mandalorian tradition, and insisted on fighting without the Force. Mandalore shattered Malak's jaw with a beskad strike and severed his sword arm. Malak's blade found Mandalore's throat first. He won the war's decisive moment without the Force at all.

Malak now serves as Supreme Chancellor-General of the Concordat. He wears prosthetics. In Mandalorian culture, prosthetics mark a warrior who paid the price for victory. In Republic culture, they mark a man who is no longer whole. He occupies both readings at once.

The Concordat considers him a necessary strongman holding the galaxy together. The Revanchist Remnant considers him a traitor who seized power and betrayed democratic principles. The Jedi Council considers him a fallen Jedi who never technically fell, which is worse because they cannot point to a clean moment of corruption. The Mandalorians consider him Mandalore's victor and honor-bound partner. The Keepers of Adas, if asked, would note that Malak used Sith techniques without understanding the tradition they came from, which makes him dangerous in a way an actual Sith Lord would not be. Chapter 8 covers the Concordat's institutional history. Chapter 14 covers Jedi approaches to individuals like Malak.

Malak never touched the dark side in the way the Jedi define it. He never surrendered to passion. He never sought personal power for its own sake. He authorized atrocities through rational calculation and genuine belief that fewer people would die this way. The Jedi Code has no category for a man who commits monstrous acts while maintaining emotional equilibrium.

Is Malak proof that the dark side operates through cold logic as well as hot rage? Or is he proof that the light/dark binary cannot describe what war does to decent people?

Both men weaponized the Force. Both exceeded the Council's authority. Both studied forbidden techniques. Both authorized mass casualties. Neither became a Sith in the Imperial sense. Neither embraced the light side in the Orthodox sense. They exist in the space between, in the territory where your own answer to the light/dark question determines how you judge them.

CHAPTER 6
THE FORCE IN CRISIS

Jedi are less effective than they used to be. The Jedi healers who once staffed Republic medical facilities with near-miraculous capability now fail as often as they succeed. The Jedi mediators who once resolved planetary disputes through Force-enhanced empathy now arrive at negotiations with the same blind spots as everyone else. The Jedi warriors who once moved with supernatural speed and foresight now hesitate, miscalculate, and die in engagements they would have won a decade ago.

People who live near dead zones report specific, observable effects: mechanical failures in equipment that worked fine elsewhere, communication blackouts, navigation errors, and a pervasive unease that even non-Force-sensitive individuals describe as "wrongness." Animals avoid dead zones. Plants grow strangely in their periphery. Weather patterns shift near the larger ones in ways that meteorologists cannot account for through conventional atmospheric models.

WHAT THE JEDI BELIEVE

The Jedi Council's official position: the Force is damaged, possibly by the massed Sith rituals of the Great Hyperspace War, possibly compounded by the Ashen Campaigns. Using the Force carelessly in its weakened state may accelerate the deterioration. The correct response is caution, study, and minimal intervention.

This position is not unanimous even within the Council. Master Vrook argues for strict non-intervention. Master Vandar favors cautious engagement. Master Zez-Kai Ell has privately suggested that the Council's understanding of the crisis may be incomplete and that restraint based on incomplete understanding is indistinguishable from paralysis.

WHAT THE SITH BELIEVED

The Sith rituals of the Great Hyperspace War were not random acts of destruction. They were, in the Sith theological framework, applications of the Force at its highest intensity. That the rituals damaged the Force itself was not predicted by Sith theory, and the implications have fractured Sith thought in the decades since.

A handful of scholars, working from traditions older than the Sith Empire itself, argue that the light-side/dark-side framework was always an oversimplification and that the Force's deterioration is the consequence of ten thousand years of Force users on both sides treating it as a tool rather than a relationship.

WHAT ORDINARY PEOPLE THINK

Most people do not think about the Force in theological terms. They think about it in practical terms.

The kolto medic on Taris thinks *"Force healing doesn't work anymore, so I need more kolto, and kolto costs more every month."*

The freighter captain thinks *"The Perlemian run used to be safe. Now I drop out of hyperspace a day early and have to calculate the rest by hand. My astromech earns its maintenance."*

The Mandalorian patrol sergeant thinks *"We told them the Force was a crutch. We were right. They should have listened."*

The Cathar refugee thinks *"The Jedi couldn't save us because the Force was failing. Or the Jedi wouldn't save us because the Council was debating. I can't tell the difference and it doesn't matter."*

The Miraluka navigator thinks *"I see through the Force. When the Force fails, I go blind. When I go blind, my ship and everyone on it dies. I haven't told my crew how often the failures are happening."*

GALACTIC CONSEQUENCES

Combat: A Force-sensitive combatant cannot rely on precognition, telekinesis, or enhanced reflexes. Smart commanders plan for both contingencies. Soldiers who serve alongside Jedi have learned to operate as though Force support might vanish at any moment.

Governance: Without reliable Force-enhanced truth-sensing and empathic communication, mediation is slower, less certain, and more susceptible to deception.

Agriculture: On dozens of Outer Rim agriworlds, Force-sensitive cultivators maintained crop cycles, managed soil health, and sensed blight before it took root. Those cultivators still live on those worlds. Their abilities fail more each season. Onderon's jungle farms lost forty percent of their staple grain yield in 2 CE when a Force-trained agronomist couldn't detect a fungal infection spreading through the root system. Dantooine's kath herders report similar losses. The Concordat has dispatched agricultural droids to compensate, but droids read soil chemistry, not the deeper biological rhythms the cultivators once tracked. Famine has not arrived. Harvests shrink, and the people who depend on them notice.

Infrastructure: Force-enhanced construction shaped cities across the galaxy for millennia. Coruscant's deep foundations, Taris's Upper City supports, the bridges on Onderon: all built or maintained by specialists who used telekinesis and structural intuition to detect stress fractures, reinforce load-bearing elements, and shape materials at molecular scale. Those specialists are aging out of the workforce, and their abilities are unreliable. Taris's infrastructure bureau has tripled its droid maintenance crews. On Dantooine, a retaining wall near the Jedi Enclave collapsed in 3 CE because the engineer who maintained it through the Force hadn't been able to sense its stress points in months. No one died. The next failure might be different.

Communication: The Jedi maintained a galaxy-wide communication relay through Force-enhanced meditation: battle meditation for fleet coordination, empathic links between Jedi stationed on distant worlds, precognitive dispatches that arrived before the events they described. All of these are gone or intermittent. The holonet carries the load now, but the holonet has bandwidth limits, transmission delays, and dead zones where signals degrade. A Concordat admiral coordinating a patrol across three sectors used to have a Jedi liaison who could sense fleet movements in real time. Now she has encrypted holonet channels and a twelve-minute signal lag.

Spirituality: Billions of beings understood the Force as the binding energy of life. Its deterioration has cracked open every religious tradition that touches it. The Jedi, the Sith, the Order of Shasa, the Baran Do Sages, village shamans on a hundred Outer Rim worlds. On Haruun Kal, the Korunnai jungle-seers have stopped receiving visions for the first time in recorded memory.

The Baran Do Sages of Dorin, who have predicted weather patterns through the Force for centuries, issued their first incorrect forecast in 1 CE; three storms hit populated areas without warning. Each tradition frames the crisis differently. None of them have answers.

Daily life: The crisis registers in accumulation. Kolto costs more because Force healing covers less. Travel takes longer because hyperspace routes near dead zones need manual recalculation. Construction projects run over schedule because the specialists who reinforced structures through the Force can't do it reliably. Food costs more on worlds that depended on Force-sensitive agriculture. Medical wait times lengthen. Infrastructure repair backlogs grow. No single failure is catastrophic. The sum of them reshapes how ordinary people plan their weeks, spend their credits, and think about the future.

DEAD ZONE SEVERITY

Dead zones vary. Some stutter. Some scream. The campaign uses a three-tier scale to describe how bad a given zone is.

Partial dead zone. The Force works intermittently. A Force user feels her abilities flicker like a lamp with a bad connection. Techniques succeed about half the time. A partial dead zone covers a region where the Force was weakened but not destroyed: the edges of major dead zones, areas where Sith rituals left residual damage, the fringes of the Kashyyyk Shadowlands.

Significant dead zone. The Force resists use. Every technique requires more effort and concentration than it should. A Jedi attempting telekinesis in a significant dead zone feels the Force respond sluggishly, like moving through water. Precognition delivers fragments instead of visions. Healing takes longer and accomplishes less. These zones surround areas of heavy Force damage: the space near Onderon, the Perlemian corridor dead patches, the expanding zones Kael Draven has been mapping for two years.

Total dead zone. The Force is absent. Telekinesis fails. Precognition goes silent. Healing produces nothing. A Miraluka goes blind. A lightsaber still ignites (it is a plasma weapon powered by a crystal, not the Force) but the precognition, enhanced reflexes, and combat awareness that make a lightsaber master lethal do not function. A Jedi in a total dead zone holds a glowing sword with no supernatural advantage. The Kashyyyk Shadowlands where the Star Map was destroyed. Whatever Onderon's jungle became after the Second Siege.

Force-related injuries and consequences heal slower inside dead zones, or not at all. A Jedi whose Force connection was damaged in a total dead zone may need to leave the zone entirely before recovery begins.

THE RAKATA

Thirty thousand years before the Concordat Era, the Rakata ruled a galaxy-spanning empire powered by the Force engineering. They built machines that drew on the Force as an energy source: hyperdrives that navigated through Force currents, terraformers that reshaped planetary ecosystems through Force manipulation, and at the apex of their civilization, the **Star Forge**.

The Star Forge orbits a star in the Lehon system, deep in the Unknown Regions. It is a factory the size of a small moon. It draws energy from the star it orbits and from the Force itself, converting both into raw material: ships, weapons, droids, armor, anything its operators can conceive. At its height, the Star Forge produced entire fleets in days. It won the Rakata their empire and then consumed them.

The Rakata's collapse followed a pattern that Force scholars recognized: they used the Force as a resource, and the resource ran out. Operators who used the Star Forge grew more aggressive as dark-side energy fed back into them, accelerating a feedback loop of conquest, consumption, and corruption. The Rakata's slave species revolted. A plague swept through the Rakata population. Their Force sensitivity deteriorated. Without the Force, their technology stopped working. Without their technology, their empire collapsed.

Within a few centuries, the Rakata went from ruling the galaxy to squatting in the ruins of their own monuments, unable to open doors their ancestors had built.

Why the Rakata Matter Now

The Rakatan collapse is the historical precedent for the current Force crisis. A civilization that built everything on the Force, lost the Force, and died.

Revan noticed the parallels. He was not the first. The Jedi Archives on Ossus contained fragmentary references to the Infinite Empire before they burned in the Great Hyperspace War. Sith scholars on Korriban maintained their own records of Rakatan ruins found in the Stygian Caldera (the nebula surrounding Sith space) and interpreted them through a Sith theological lens: the Rakata were a warning about what happens when a civilization relies on Force power without the discipline to sustain it.

The difference between the Rakatan collapse and the current crisis is speed. The Rakata declined over centuries. The galaxy's current Force deterioration has accelerated in the twelve years since the Great Hyperspace War at a rate no model predicts. Whether the cause is the Sith rituals, the Ashen Campaigns, some deeper structural failure, or something no one has identified yet is the campaign's central mystery.

THE STAR FORGE

Whether the Star Forge is operational, dormant, or destroyed remains unknown. Revan believes he located it. His research notes reference "the station" and "the engine" in ways that suggest he found something in the Lehon system. What matters for the galaxy is that the possibility of the Star Forge drives faction behavior:

- If the Star Forge exists and can be activated, whoever controls it can build an infinite fleet.
- If the Star Forge exists and requires the Force to operate, then in a galaxy where the Force is dying, it may be the thing that finishes the job.
- If Revan found it and it broke him, that is its own kind of answer.

Factions will pursue it. Players will hear about it. What the Star Forge is, and what it does if activated, belongs to the campaign's arc.

THE STAR MAPS

The Rakata built Star Maps as navigational monuments: self-sustaining holographic systems, powered by the Force, that recorded the location of the Star Forge and other key Infinite Empire installations. Five Star Maps were scattered across the galaxy on worlds significant to the Rakata: Dantooine, Kashyyyk, Manaan, Tatooine, and Korriban.

The maps were designed to be self-repairing. When the Rakata destroyed them during their collapse (to prevent their slave species from seizing the Star Forge), the maps slowly reconstructed themselves over millennia, drawing on residual Force energy embedded in their construction sites.

What each faction knows about the Star Maps varies with their access to Revan's research, their own archaeological records, and the accidents of geography.

Dantooine

Intact but partially degraded. Located in Rakatan ruins near the Jedi Enclave.

Jedi scholars at the enclave studied it for decades without understanding what it was. **Concordat** military surveys have catalogued the ruins as low priority. **Remnant** intelligence knows Revan studied this map before forming the Revanchists; his notes reference it as one of five. When the Mandalorians established their presence on Dantooine, the map fell into a contested zone. Its current status is uncertain: the enclave may have moved it, the Mandalorians may have seized it, or it may still be sitting in the ruins, guarded by nothing but geography and Force-sensitive fauna.

Kashyyyk

Destroyed. A dead zone marks where it stood in the Shadowlands.

Remnant records confirm Revan's forces located the Star Map during Year Five of the Mandalorian Wars. After extracting the navigational data, Revan ordered the map demolished to prevent anyone from following his trail. Wookiee elders who witnessed the destruction reported that the ruins "screamed" in the Force when the map was broken. **Most factions** know a dead zone exists in the Shadowlands but not why. The dead zone around the former map site has not healed.

Manaan

Intact and hidden. Submerged deep beneath Ahto City, in the ocean trenches near the Hrakert Rift, the deep-sea geological formation where kolto is produced.

The Selkath know about the Rakatan ruins. They have known for longer than the Republic has existed. The **Order of Shasa** (the Selkath Force tradition) maintains the site as a sacred place and does not discuss it with outsiders. The connection between the Star Map, the Hrakert Rift, and kolto's Force-resonant properties is not a coincidence, and the Selkath know more about this relationship than they share. **Other factions** suspect Rakatan ruins exist in Manaan's deep ocean but have no access.

Tatooine

Destroyed.

Remnant intelligence indicates that Malak's forces located this map during Year Six, acting on intelligence separate from Revan's research. Malak destroyed it. He recognized what the Star Forge represented: an infinite factory powered by the Force. He concluded that in a galaxy where the Force was dying, an engine that consumed the Force to produce weapons was the last thing anyone needed. His destruction of the Tatooine map was a strategic decision. It may have been the most morally clear decision Malak has ever made. **Concordat** records do not publicize this event. **Most people** have no idea the map existed.

Korriban

Intact but corrupted. The Star Map in the Valley of the Dark Lords has been there since before the Dark Jedi Exiles arrived to found the Sith Empire. It predates everything the Sith built on Korriban.

Sith traditionalists and **Keepers of Adas** know the map is ancient, their oral traditions connect it to King Adas's war against the Rakata twenty-seven thousand years ago. Sith sorcerers drew on its residual Force energy for millennia without understanding its origin. By the Concordat Era, the Korriban map is saturated with dark-side energy accumulated over thousands of years of Sith ritual practice. Whether it still functions as a navigational tool is unclear. What it has become, a Force artifact soaked in millennia of death, is something else entirely. **Other factions** know Korriban's reputation and stay away. Few outside the Sith know the map exists.

CHAPTER 7
HISTORY OF THE CONCORDAT ERA

BBY	EVENT	CONCORDAT CALENDAR
3964	Great Hyperspace War ends. The Sith Empire collapses. The Force sustains catastrophic damage from massed Sith ritual warfare.	9 BC
3963	Mandalore the Vindicated's gathering on Dxun. Adoption of the Doctrine of Necessary Strength.	8 BC
3962	**Year One of the Mandalorian Wars.** Siege of Taris. The Mandalorian expansion begins.	7 BC
3961	Onderon Campaign. Beast Riders earn alliance. Sixty systems under Mandalorian influence.	6 BC
3960	Serroco Resource Pact. Eighty systems. Mandalorian administrative failures accelerate.	5 BC
3959	**Year Four.** The Razing of Cathar. The Revanchists form under Revan. First Revanchist victories.	4 BC
3958	The Battle of Jebble. Malak takes operational command. Revan's research into Sith artifacts intensifies. Serroco Atrocity.	3 BC
3957	**The Ashen Campaigns begin.** Force weaponized at strategic scale. First confirmed wounds in the Force tied to combat operations.	2 BC
3956	The Ashen Campaigns escalate. The Burning of Duro. The Siege of Onderon (Second). Dead zones proliferate.	1 BC
3955	**Year Seven.** Malak's Dhas'kara challenge. The Concordat signed. Canderous Ordo forms the Neo-Mandalorian Coalition.	1 CE
3954	Concordat consolidation. Senate ratification. Malak appointed Supreme Chancellor-General. Admiral Kaeranth extracts Revan. Revanchist Remnant established.	2 CE
3953	Jedi Council authorizes the Sentinel Program under Master Kavar, designed by Atris. Sith Triumvirate consolidation in the shadows.	3 CE
3952	**Campaign start. Revan returns from the Unknown Regions. The Freighter Incident.**	**4 CE**

THE GREAT HYPERSPACE WAR

The Great Hyperspace War in this setting is not distant ancient history. It ended twelve years before the campaign starts. The veterans are middle-aged. The orphans are young adults.

The Sith Empire under **Naga Sadow** launched an invasion of the Republic that came closer to succeeding than any official history admits. Sith battle fleets struck the Core Worlds. Sith sorcerers performed ritual warfare on a scale the galaxy had never seen: mass sacrifice, reality distortion, Force-severing techniques that could strip Jedi of their abilities mid-battle.

On **Ossus**, the Jedi Archives burned. Ten thousand Jedi fought the Sith war machine, and when the massed rituals peaked, the defenders felt something unprecedented: silence. Not the quiet of a calm mind, but the silence of a severed connection. For minutes that stretched like hours, the Force vanished from Ossus. Jedi who had relied on precognition for decades fought blind. Jedi healers watched patients die under their hands. Some collapsed, unable to process the absence.

The Republic won because the Sith rituals were unstable. The sorcery that severed Jedi also consumed Sith practitioners. Naga Sadow's forces imploded as their own weapons devoured them. The Republic counter-invasion shattered what remained of the Sith Empire and drove the survivors into the Unknown Regions and the fringes of Wild Space.

The victory was pyrrhic. The war severed trade routes and depopulated entire sectors. The Core Worlds bore bombardment scars that would take generations to repair. And the Jedi whispered about something worse: the Force itself was damaged. Not on Ossus alone, but spreading. Places where Sith rituals had been performed became dead zones. The zones kept growing.

The Republic needed resources to rebuild. Cortosis for hull plating. Durasteel for infrastructure. Kolto for the millions of wounded. Fuel for the shattered fleet. Food for the displaced.

The richest resource worlds in the Outer Rim belonged to the Mandalorian clans.

The Doctrine of Necessary Strength

Three months after the Treaty of Coruscant ended the Great Hyperspace War, Mandalore the Vindicated called every major clan to the jungle moon of Dxun. Ordo, Vizla, Skirata, Cadera, Fett, Kryze. They expected a war cry.

He showed them a Jedi dying.

> The hologram was a battlefield recording from Ossus. A Twi'lek Jedi Master named Rell Odar, one of the finest duelists of his generation, fighting Sith warriors with extraordinary skill. Then the Sith ritual hit. His lightsaber flickered. His enhanced speed vanished. His precognition evaporated. He stood there, confused, and blaster bolts cut him down.
>
> Mandalore replayed it three times.

The argument: for ten thousand years, the galaxy had built its civilization on the assumption that the Force existed and that Force users would protect it. The Sith had demonstrated that assumption could be destroyed. The Jedi Council debated in their temples while people starved. The Republic Senate issued decrees that no fleet could enforce. The galaxy was fragile, dependent, and one catastrophe away from collapse.

The Mandalorians, who had never relied on the Force, who fought with iron and will and discipline, were the only people who could teach the galaxy to survive without supernatural crutches.

The **Doctrine of Necessary Strength** was not a declaration of war. It was a philosophy of intervention. The Mandalorians would demonstrate self-reliance by testing the galaxy's ability to defend itself, and offer their methods to those who proved willing to learn.

The clans adopted it within days. Not unanimously. Clan Kryze argued that demonstration could be achieved through diplomacy rather than siege. Cassus Fett of Clan Fett saw an opportunity for territorial expansion dressed in ideological clothing and said so, earning both contempt and respect for his honesty. But the core held: the Mandalorians would move outward, and the galaxy would learn or fall.

THE MANDALORIAN WAR

The Siege of Taris (3962 BBY)

Taris was the template. The Mandalorians surrounded the city-world, issued a challenge — prove you can defend yourselves without the Republic — and waited. For four months they held the perimeter while Coruscant promised relief that never came.

When the Tarisian militia tried to break the siege, the Mandalorians crushed them in six hours. Then they did something no one expected: they offered the survivors training. A third accepted. When those soldiers returned weeks later, they were transformed. Disciplined, effective, dangerous. They still lost the rematch, but they'd earned something the Republic had never given them: Mandalorian respect.

Taris surrendered not because it was conquered but because the Mandalorians offered something the Republic couldn't: protection that arrived. In exchange, Taris provided resources and a commitment to self-defense infrastructure.

Two-thirds of Taris accepted the arrangement. The Undercity, the lowest levels where the displaced and the desperate lived, accepted almost unanimously. For people the Republic had already abandoned, Mandalorian pragmatism was an improvement.

The upper city resisted. Tarisian nobles who'd relied on Republic trade agreements and Senate connections found themselves irrelevant. Some fled to Coruscant. Some hired mercenaries. Some adapted.

The Onderon Campaign (3961 BBY)

Onderon was the proof of concept. The beast-riders of Onderon fought the Mandalorian advance with a ferocity that earned genuine admiration. Clan Ordo bore the brunt: Canderous Ordo, young and aggressive, led the assault on the Onderon jungle and lost thirty warriors in the first week to beast-rider ambushes. He called it the best fighting he'd ever seen.

Half of Onderon earned alliance through combat rather than subjugation. The beast-riders became Mandalorian auxiliaries, keeping their traditions and customs while integrating into the clan military structure. Queen Talia of Onderon maintained her throne on the condition that Onderon raised a standing militia to Mandalorian standards.

The arrangement worked. Onderon became the model for what the Mandalorians called *aliit'alor* — honoured integration. A conquered world that fought well was not subjugated but adopted.

Dantooine (3961 BBY)

Dantooine fell without a shot. The Mandalorians established a presence on the plains outside the Jedi Enclave and waited. Colonists came to them. Young farmers looked at the enclave, where Jedi Masters debated whether using the Force was accelerating its death, and then at the Mandalorian camp, where instructors taught blade combat and survival skills to anyone willing. They made a pragmatic choice.

The Jedi Enclave Council protested. The Mandalorians invited them to stop the migration by offering something better. The Council debated this for three weeks. By then, half the settlement had relocated.

Serroco (3960 BBY)

Serroco traded cortosis mining access for defense. The native Stereb population had been caught between Republic mining corporations (primarily Czerka) and Mandalorian expansion. They chose the side that would garrison their cities rather than extract their resources from orbit.

The Serroco Resource Pact became a model for economic integration. Mandalorian clans provided military infrastructure. Serroco provided cortosis, fuel, and food. The arrangement was efficient, functional, and exploitative in ways neither side acknowledged.

The Administrative Crisis

By Year Three, the Mandalorians held eighty systems and couldn't run any of them. Taris experienced food distribution failures within months. Trade networks collapsed under Mandalorian military administration. Their warrior culture had no framework for civilian governance, economic management, or bureaucratic coordination.

Cassus Fett saw this first. A cold-eyed logistician who'd always been more comfortable with spreadsheets than with honor codes, Fett argued that the Mandalorians needed to recruit administrators — non-warriors who could manage grain distribution and taxation. The traditionalists called this weakness. Fett called it mathematics.

Veera Ordo, Canderous's younger sister, supported Fett. She'd been arguing for administrative partnership since before the expansion. She was also the first prominent Mandalorian to suggest that the Doctrine of Necessary Strength might apply to governance as well as warfare: if the Mandalorians couldn't govern, they should learn, not pretend the problem didn't exist.

The Republic, meanwhile, did nothing. The Senate debated jurisdiction while worlds fell. The Jedi Council argued about whether the Force was too damaged to risk using in combat, whether intervening would make the fractures worse, whether intervention was even possible when half their combat-trained Knights could no longer trust their precognition.

The Razing of Cathar

The Cathar refused the Mandalorian offer. Not with negotiation or with the organized militia resistance Taris had attempted. The Cathar fought a guerrilla campaign — brutal, decentralized, and devastating to Mandalorian supply lines. They used their homeworld's dense forests and canyon systems to ambush Mandalorian patrols. They poisoned water supplies. They targeted officers.

The Mandalorian response escalated over months. What began as a standard pacification became a systematic campaign against the civilian infrastructure that supported the guerrillas. Mandalorian doctrine held that a people who refused to fight in open combat with identifiable combatants forfeited the protections of honorable war. The Cathar fought as insurgents, and the Mandalorians treated them as insurgents.

Cassus Fett commanded the Cathar operation. His methods were efficient and monstrous. He separated Cathar populations from their forest strongholds through controlled burning. He established concentration zones where his troops held civilians while Mandalorian forces swept the guerrilla networks. He did not order the massacre that followed.

What happened at the Cathar Concentration at Ves'kaan was a breakdown of discipline, not a strategy. Mandalorian forces under Clan Jendri, enraged after three months of insurgent ambushes that had killed their chieftain's children, entered the Ves'kaan zone and killed approximately fourteen thousand Cathar civilians over two days. Fett's official report classified it as "collateral pacification." He did not punish the perpetrators. He noted in private correspondence to Mandalore that "the Cathar problem is resolved" and moved to the next system.

The galaxy learned about Ves'kaan from refugees who escaped through the forest. A Cathar teenager named Sylvar Juhani recorded the aftermath with a stolen Mandalorian unit: burning villages, mass graves, Mandalorian warriors firing into crowds. It was the first time most Republic citizens saw what the Expansion looked like when a world refused to cooperate.

The Revanchists Form

Revan watched the Cathar footage in the Coruscant Temple. He'd been arguing with the Council for a year. The footage ended the argument.

He walked out of the Temple with four hundred Jedi behind him.

Some followed because they believed the Council's inaction was a betrayal of everything the Jedi were supposed to be. Some followed because they were young and angry and Revan was the most charismatic person they'd ever met. Some followed because they'd been watching the Force deteriorate and decided that passivity was killing them faster than war.

Revan addressed his followers in the plaza outside the Temple. He did not give a rousing speech. He said: *"The Council believes that inaction will preserve the Force. I believe that the Force is dying because we have allowed suffering we could have prevented. Both positions may be wrong. But only one of them requires us to do nothing while fourteen thousand people are buried in mass graves."*

Within three months, Republic military units joined the Revanchists: volunteers, defectors from garrisons ordered to stand down, fleet officers who'd filed protest reports that vanished into Senate committees.

The Serroco Atrocity (3958 BBY)

The Mandalorians demonstrated that Cathar was not an isolated failure of discipline. When the native Stereb population of Serroco began aiding Revanchist intelligence operations, the Mandalorian garrison commander, acting on standing orders to maintain security at any cost, ordered the orbital bombardment of Serroco's native cities. Not the Republic mining installations. Not the military facilities. The twelve largest Stereb population centers. The cortosis mines were untouched.

The message was legible from orbit: the infrastructure matters. The people are replaceable.

Cathar was a massacre born of rage. Serroco was a calculation.

Serroco radicalized the Revanchists in ways that Cathar had not. Malak, who had been managing logistics and troop movements while Revan planned grand strategy, looked at Serroco and began thinking about how wars end. Not how you win battles, but how you make wars stop.

REVANCHIST WAR EFFORT

Two years of fighting showed who Revan and Malak were. Revan was a philosopher-general who understood war as a problem of knowledge. He identified which planets mattered, how to frame the conflict for public support, where to apply pressure to fracture Mandalorian alliances. His strategic plans were elegant, ambitious, and frequently disconnected from the logistical reality of feeding an army in contested space.

Malak understood supply lines, troop movements, attrition rates, and the brutal mathematics of a war fought across hundreds of systems. When historians later reviewed Revanchist victories, they found Revan's name on the strategic directives and Malak's signature on the tactical execution orders. Revan inspired the troops. Malak kept them fed and alive.

The Battle of Jebble (3958 BBY) was the template. Revan's intelligence network identified Jebble as a Mandalorian supply nexus. His plan called for a diversionary attack on three neighboring systems to draw Mandalorian reserves, followed by a precision strike on Jebble's orbital defenses. Malak executed the plan, adapted it twice when intelligence proved faulty, and took the system in nine days with a casualty rate of twelve percent. Revan called it a vindication of Revanchist strategy. Malak called it expensive.

They needed each other. The problem was that Revan stopped needing the war.

Revan's Obsession

In captured Mandalorian archives, Revan found references to ruins in the Unknown Regions — structures built by an ancient civilization called the Rakata, who had built an empire on the Force and then lost it. Revan became convinced that understanding the Rakatan collapse was the key to understanding the current Force crisis.

He chased Star Map fragments across the Outer Rim. He acquired Sith holocrons from black-market dealers and from Korriban tomb raiders. He cross-referenced Rakatan architectural signatures with Sith historical records. His personal journal from this period reads like the work of a man who found a thread in a tapestry and believed that if he pulled hard enough, the entire design would reveal itself.

By late 3958, Revan spent more time in research than in command meetings. Malak watched his commander vanish into scholarship while the war bled the Revanchists dry.

THE ASHEN CAMPAIGNS

By Year Six, the Revanchist war effort was stalling. The Mandalorians recruited from every conquered world, turning former Republic citizens into effective soldiers within weeks. Force abilities were becoming unreliable: Malak had felt his own powers flicker in combat, had seen dead zones where Jedi abilities stopped working mid-engagement. The Revanchists were fighting with conventional forces supplemented by unpredictable Force users.

Malak commissioned a study of Revanchist Force-user effectiveness. The results were classified. The summary: Force-augmented combat units had suffered a thirty-one percent decline in operational reliability over two years. Precognition failures had caused friendly-fire incidents. Healing failures had increased field mortality. The Force was not a force multiplier anymore. It was a liability that occasionally worked.

Revan, from whatever research station he was operating from, sent Malak a package. Inside were the decoded techniques from a Sith holocron — a methodology for channeling the Force through multiple practitioners simultaneously, producing effects no individual user could achieve. The ancient Sith had used massed ritual to crack Jedi defenses during the Great Hyperspace War.

Revan's attached note read: *They used this to destroy. We can use it to win. The difference is intent.*

Malak saw something Revan hadn't: scale. If you could coordinate Force users to amplify each other's abilities, you could compensate for individual unreliability through sheer numbers. Twenty unreliable Force users channeling in concert might produce one reliable result.

The first coordinated Force operation — the Battle of Omonoth — used thirty-seven Revanchist Jedi channeling together to generate a telekinetic shockwave that disabled a Mandalorian orbital defense platform. It worked. The Jedi involved reported headaches, nosebleeds, and a hollow sensation in the Force that lasted for days.

By the fifth operation, the Revanchists had developed a tactical doctrine around coordinated Force strikes: *Ashfall Operations*, named for the particulate debris that choked the atmosphere after a strike. The Jedi who participated called them Ashen Campaigns. The name stuck.

What the Ashen Campaigns Did

The Ashen Campaigns were effective. They broke Mandalorian defensive positions that conventional forces couldn't crack. They terrorized Mandalorian garrisons. They turned the tide of the war in sectors where the Revanchists had been losing for years.

They also tore wounds in the Force that have never healed.

Each coordinated Force strike consumed something. The Jedi who participated described it as spending currency that could not be replenished. After an Ashen strike, the affected area became a dead zone.

The first dead zones were small. A battlefield. A crater. A few square kilometers. By the end of the Ashen Campaigns, entire regions of space were compromised. The Burning of **Duro** — an Ashen strike aimed at a Mandalorian shipyard in orbit — created a dead zone that encompassed the planet's upper atmosphere. Duro's surface, already polluted by centuries of industry, became a world where the Force was gone, where Force-sensitive refugees reported constant pain, where the ecosystem began dying in ways that biologists couldn't explain because the mechanisms were metaphysical.

Forty-one confirmed Ashen operations were conducted over fourteen months. The Revanchists won thirty-four of the associated engagements. Twelve planets sustained permanent Force damage. An estimated six hundred thousand civilians died in the operations or their immediate aftermath.

Malak authorized every operation. He read the damage reports. He signed the next order.

His reasoning was consistent: the Mandalorians would not stop. The Republic could not sustain a conventional war. The Force was dying anyway. If using it as a weapon accelerated the death of something that was already dying, the calculation was acceptable. Every Ashen strike shortened the war. Every shortened week saved conventional casualties that would have been spent in grinding attrition.

The mathematics were defensible. The mathematics were monstrous. Malak knew both things and did not stop.

THE SECOND SIEGE OF ONDERON (3956 BBY)

The Ashen Campaigns reached their apex and their moral nadir at **Onderon**. The beast-riders, who had been Mandalorian allies since Year Two, had fortified Onderon into a Mandalorian stronghold. Conventional assault would have cost fifty thousand Revanchist lives.

Malak ordered a full Ashen strike on the Onderon jungle. Sixty Jedi channeled together. The strike shattered the Mandalorian defensive perimeter and created a corridor for ground assault. It also killed the jungle. Thousands of square kilometers of forest died in minutes as the Force was ripped from the ecosystem. The beasts the riders had bonded with — creatures connected to their riders through the Force — went mad, turning on their riders, on civilians, on each other.

The beast-riders, who had earned Mandalorian respect through the purest form of Mandalorian honor, died screaming alongside their animals in a forest that was consuming itself.

Revanchist ground forces entered the dead zone and took Onderon in three days.

Mandalorian Ideological Defeat

The Mandalorians did not break because of the Ashen Campaigns alone. They broke because Malak understood something about Mandalorian culture that Revan never had: the Mandalorians did not fear death, but they feared irrelevance.

The Ashen Campaigns demonstrated that the Force — the thing the Doctrine of Necessary Strength had dismissed as a crutch — could be used to annihilate Mandalorian forces with an efficiency that training and discipline could not match. The Mandalorians had built their philosophy on the premise that skill and will were superior to supernatural power. The Ashen Campaigns proved that premise wrong. Not through individual Jedi heroism, but through industrialized Force application — the exact kind of systematic strength the Mandalorians respected.

THE DHAS'KARA

Malak had spent two years studying Mandalorian culture while commanding the Revanchist military. He learned their honor codes, their customs, their respect for strength demonstrated through personal combat. He learned about Dhas'kara — single combat challenges that could resolve disputes between clans, even challenges to Mandalore himself.

He understood the Right of Challenge: anyone could challenge Mandalorian authority by proving superior individual strength. No outsider had ever done so.

He did not tell Revan. Revan was deep in the Unknown Regions by then, chasing Star Map fragments, sending intermittent transmissions about Rakatan infinity engines. Their last substantive conversation had been six months prior.

Malak sent a transmission to Mandalore the Vindicated. He invoked Dhas'kara. If Malak won, Mandalore would hear his terms. If Mandalore won, the Revanchists would surrender. Under Mandalorian law, refusing a properly invoked challenge destroyed the authority of the one who refused. Mandalore had no option.

They fought in orbit above Dxun for four hours. No Force powers. Malak refused to use them. He insisted on meeting the Mandalorian standard: iron and will, nothing else.

Mandalore the Vindicated shattered Malak's jaw with a beskad strike and severed his sword arm. Malak's blade found Mandalore's throat first.

Victory. By rights, Malak could demand anything — including Mandalore's death. He demanded partnership.

FOUNDING OF THE CONCORDAT

Malak stood over Mandalore with blood pouring from where his jaw had been, his severed arm cauterized by emergency systems, and offered terms for what would become the **Concordat**: Mandalorian clans provide military strength and maintain their warrior culture. Republic systems provide economic administration and civilian governance. Resources flow to where they're needed. Defense goes to worlds that maintain militias and contribute to collective security. No more Senate debates while worlds burn. No more Mandalorian warriors managing grain distribution.

Mandalore, alive through Malak's mercy and bound by Ka'halar — in Mandalorian tradition, the life-debt owed by a defeated opponent who is spared by his victor, a bond as binding as blood oath — accepted.

Not all the clans followed. Canderous Ordo and the traditionalists saw it as surrender dressed in alliance and walked. They formed the Neo-Mandalorian Coalition: a rejection of both the Concordat and the Remnant, committed to Mandalorian independence through honorable combat.

The pragmatists joined immediately. Cassus Fett's faction, calculating as always, saw the economic logic and moved first. Much of Clan Vizla followed, as did Veera Ordo, who had been arguing for administrative partnership for years and finally had an ally with the authority to implement it.

PRESENT DAY

Three years have passed. The Concordat has consolidated power across the Core Worlds and much of the Inner Rim. The Remnant has survived three years of guerrilla warfare through Kaeranth's competence. The Neo-Mandalorian Coalition has carved a nomadic existence out of the Outer Rim's margins. The Jedi Order has fractured beyond recognition.

The Sith, presumed destroyed, are not gone. In the shadows, something is consolidating scattered Sith remnants toward a purpose that none of the three major governments have identified. The galaxy has forgotten about the Sith. The Sith have not forgotten about the galaxy.

PART II: WHO HOLDS POWER

CHAPTER 8

THE CONCORDAT

What they claim: The Concordat is the legitimate successor to the Galactic Republic, enhanced by the military strength of the Mandalorian clans and the administrative reforms necessary to prevent the governance failures that allowed the Mandalorian Wars to happen. Emergency powers are temporary measures required by an ongoing security crisis.

What they do: The Concordat governs approximately four hundred major systems and claims authority over another six hundred in various stages of integration or contestation. Core World governance resembles the old Republic with added security apparatus. Mid Rim governance operates through military governors with broad discretionary authority. Outer Rim territories are garrison states where Mandalorian clan forces provide security and Republic-trained administrators manage resource extraction.

Force-sensitive citizens within Concordat territory are required to register with the Office of Force Affairs. The stated purpose is public safety. The unstated purpose is political control: Force users are the Remnant's most effective operatives, and the Concordat treats unregistered Force sensitives as potential insurgents.

THE CHANCELLOR-GENERAL

The Republic Senate ratified the Concordat by the narrowest margin in its history. Malak was appointed Supreme Chancellor-General — a new position combining civil and military authority. Constitutional scholars protested. Military pragmatists celebrated. Most citizens were too exhausted to care.

Malak's model was not tyranny. It was the Consulate: a government that maintained democratic forms while concentrating executive authority in a leader who could act. The Senate continued to meet. Senators continued to debate. Legislation continued to pass. But the Chancellor-General held emergency powers with no expiration date, military authority that superseded civilian jurisdiction in "contested territories" (a category that Malak's office defined), and the power to appoint military governors to systems deemed "insufficiently stabilized."

Malak the Man

Malak wears prosthetics for his jaw and arm. In Mandalorian culture, prosthetics mark a warrior who paid the price for victory. In Republic culture, they mark a man who is no longer whole. Malak occupies both readings at once, and the ambiguity is useful.

He governs from Coruscant, from the same Senate chambers where Republic Chancellors governed before him. He holds audiences. He meets with senators. He reviews military reports. He sleeps four hours a night and drinks caf that his aide, Lieutenant Commander Vynn Telos, describes as "weaponized."

He is not a monster. He is a man who made a series of decisions that each seemed necessary at the time and that, taken together, have built something that looks like an authoritarian state. He monitored Force-sensitive individuals because unreliable Force users posed a security risk. He expanded military governor authority because contested territories needed rapid decision-making. He curtailed press freedoms because wartime propaganda was destabilizing newly integrated Mandalorian worlds.

Each decision had a defensible justification. Each decision made the next one easier.

Malak is aware of what he is becoming. He has private conversations, recorded in journals that are not public, where he asks himself whether the Concordat is a transitional government or a permanent one. He does not have an answer. The galaxy is not stable enough to test the question.

INTERNAL FACTIONS

The Integrationists follow Veera Ordo and elements of Cassus Fett's faction. They believe the Concordat should evolve into a genuine hybrid government with permanent Mandalorian representation in Republic institutions. They push for cultural exchange programs, joint military academies, and the legal recognition of Mandalorian customs within Republic law.

The Restorationists are former Republic senators and administrators who accepted the Concordat as a wartime necessity and want to restore full democratic governance as soon as the security situation permits. They support Malak's authority reluctantly and push constantly for timelines, sunset clauses, and the restoration of Senate oversight. Their leader in the Senate is Senator Lorso of Telos, a pragmatist who despises Malak personally but recognizes that removing him would create a power vacuum.

The Militarists are Malak's core supporters: military officers, Mandalorian chieftains, and security-state architects who believe the galaxy's crisis requires permanent centralized authority. Their most visible advocate is **General Tagren Voss**, a career Republic officer who commanded the rearguard at the Burning of Duro and has not forgotten what happens when governments deliberate while people die. Voss chairs the Concordat Security Council and has pushed for expanded surveillance of Force-sensitive populations, mandatory military service in contested territories, and the classification of Remnant sympathizers as enemy combatants rather than political dissidents. He is effective, popular with the military, and exactly the kind of person that Restorationists point to when they argue the Concordat is sliding toward permanent martial law.

MANDALORE THE VINDICATED

Mandalore occupies a unique position. Bound by Ka'halar to Malak, he serves as a formal advisor with the title of Lord Marshal — a Mandalorian term reforged for Republic consumption. He attends Concordat military councils. He provides insight into Mandalorian clan politics. He is, in essence, a hostage dressed as a partner. He knows this. Malak knows this. Neither acknowledges it publicly. Mandalore's presence legitimizes the Concordat to Mandalorian clans. His captivity guarantees their compliance. The arrangement is stable so long as no one examines it too closely.

Concordat Character Hooks

- A military officer navigating the tensions between Republic and Mandalorian command traditions
- A bureaucrat in the Office of Force Affairs who's started to doubt the program's purpose
- A Mandalorian warrior serving in a joint unit who respects her Republic counterparts but wonders what she's fighting for
- A Restorationist senator's aide who's discovered something about the emergency powers that the Senator needs to hear

CHAPTER 9
THE REVANCHIST REMNANT

What they claim: The Remnant is the legitimate Republic. The Concordat is a military coup dressed in democratic language. Malak betrayed the principles the Revanchists fought for when he bargained with Mandalorians and consolidated power. The Remnant will restore democratic governance and end the military governor system.

What they do: The Remnant holds twenty-three systems in the Outer Rim, mostly agricultural worlds, former Jedi enclaves, and settlements that refused to recognize the Concordat's authority. Its military consists of three battle groups under Admiral Kaeranth: roughly forty capital ships and a network of hidden bases. They cannot fight the Concordat in open battle. They fight supply-line raids, intelligence operations, and propaganda campaigns aimed at Concordat worlds where dissatisfaction is highest.

Day-to-day governance falls to a triumvirate (a word they avoid, given other associations): Admiral Kaeranth commands the military. Master Dorak, a Jedi historian who left the Council, manages civilian administration. Captain Carth Onasi, a defector from the Concordat military, serves as diplomatic liaison and intelligence coordinator.

Their greatest weapon is legitimacy. Every Concordat excess — every civil liberty curtailed, every military governor who oversteps, every Force-sensitive individual detained for "security evaluation" — feeds Remnant recruitment.

ADMIRAL KAERANTH

Saul Kaeranth served under both Revan and Malak during the Mandalorian Wars. He was a career naval officer who'd risen through fleet command during the Great Hyperspace War and transferred his loyalty to the Revanchists when the Republic Senate refused to authorize military action against the Mandalorian expansion.

Kaeranth watched Malak consolidate power after the Concordat with the eye of a man who has seen strongmen before. He watched the Senate's authority erode. He watched Force-sensitive individuals placed under surveillance. He recognized the pattern: the Republic was stable, but it was no longer the Republic.

He made quiet contact with officers who felt the same way. When Revan returned from the Unknown Regions — alone, gaunt, carrying crates of datacrons and speaking in sentence fragments about things he'd seen — Kaeranth was ready. He extracted Revan with three battlegroups, enough firepower to discourage pursuit, and enough loyalist personnel to establish a government-in-exile.

At campaign start, Kaeranth is the Remnant's spine. He maintains fleet readiness. He manages the hidden base network. He negotiates through back channels with sympathetic Concordat officers who might defect if the political winds shift. He is a military pragmatist who chose the Remnant out of principle and stays because someone has to keep the lights on while Revan is... whatever Revan is becoming.

His relationship with Revan is strained. Kaeranth extracted a hero. What he got back was a man consumed by research, intermittently brilliant and frequently incoherent, who speaks about Rakatan technology and "the pattern beneath the Force" with the intensity of a prophet and the specificity of a fever dream.

Kaeranth protects Revan from the Remnant's rank and file. He filters Revan's communications. He interprets Revan's strategic directives into actionable orders when they're coherent and shelves them when they're not. He does this because the Remnant needs its figurehead, and because he still believes, against mounting evidence, that the person he followed into war is still in there somewhere.

REVAN'S RETURN

Revan spent two years in the Unknown Regions, chasing fragments of Rakatan Star Maps and the trail of the Star Forge. He found things. He has not shared all of what he found, and what he has shared does not always make sense.

He believes the Rakatan collapse and the current Force crisis share a common mechanism. He speaks in long monologues about "the pattern" — a structure he claims to perceive beneath the Force, something deeper than the light-side/dark-side binary. He sketches diagrams on any available surface. He sometimes fails to recognize people he's known for years. He sometimes demonstrates insights so precise and so far ahead of anyone else in the room that Kaeranth wonders if genius and madness are the same thing viewed from different angles.

The Remnant's rank and file are split. Some worship Revan as a returned savior. Some fear he's become the thing the Jedi Council always warned about: a Force user who chased forbidden knowledge and lost himself. Some are loyal to Kaeranth and don't particularly care what Revan thinks anymore — the Admiral keeps them fed and alive, which is more than Revan has done in two years.

Remnant Character Hooks

- A guerrilla pilot who's flown supply runs through Concordat patrols for three years and is running out of luck
- A Jedi Commander who followed Revan out of the Temple and now isn't sure what she's following
- A defector from the Concordat military who chose the Remnant because the alternative was complicity
- An intelligence operative who's seen Revan's research notes and can't decide whether they're revelation or psychosis

CHAPTER 10
THE NEO-MANDALORIANS

What they claim: The Concordat is dishonor. Mandalore lost in single combat and accepted servitude rather than death, violating the deepest tenets of Mandalorian tradition. The Neo-Mandalorians will demonstrate true Mandalorian values through combat.

What they do: The Coalition operates as a nomadic military force. Mobile bases on uninhabited moons and asteroid installations. A raiding fleet that hits Concordat and Remnant shipping. Canderous Ordo leads through personal combat prowess. He has killed seven challengers to his authority in four years. He is growing tired of killing subordinates and has not figured out how to lead without it.

The Neo-Mandalorians are not a unified faction. They are a coalition of:

- **Traditionalist clans** (Ordo loyalists, fragments of Clan Jendri, Clan Cadera's orthodox wing) who believe the Concordat violated Mandalorian honor
- **Mercenary companies** who see the Coalition as an employment opportunity
- **Ideological purists** who argue the Doctrine of Necessary Strength demands Mandalorian independence from all outsider governance
- **Refugees and outcasts** who ended up with the Coalition because no one else would take them

The Neo-Mandalorians are not villains. They are people committed to an ideal that the galaxy may have outgrown, and they have not yet decided what they're willing to sacrifice to preserve it.

CANDEROUS ORDO

Canderous fought on Onderon in Year Two. He was twenty-three years old, and the beast-riders broke his collarbone in three places before he broke their defensive line. He called it the best day of his life. He meant it. Mandalorians measure themselves against the best fight they've ever had, and Onderon was his.

He watched those same beast-riders die at the Second Siege, their bonded animals turning on them as the Ashen strike ripped the Force from the jungle. He did not call that day anything. He stopped talking about Onderon.

Canderous rejected the Concordat for reasons that are ideological and personal in ways he can no longer separate. The Doctrine of Necessary Strength says strength is self-forged. Mandalore accepted mercy from Malak. Mercy is dependency. Dependency is the thing the Doctrine was created to destroy. Canderous can follow the logic from premise to conclusion without flinching. He flinches at the part he doesn't say aloud: that Mandalore, the man he followed into the Expansion, the man who gave the Doctrine its authority, broke the Doctrine's central promise by accepting life on Malak's terms.

He leads the Coalition through combat prowess and personal conviction. Seven challengers in four years. Each one forced him to kill a subordinate to retain command. Mandalorian law permits this. Mandalorian culture respects it. Canderous does not sleep well after any of them. He has begun to suspect that a leader who must kill his own people to maintain authority is not leading but surviving, and that the distinction matters.

His sister Veera chose the Concordat. They have not spoken since the split. Canderous keeps a holographic message she sent him, three sentences asking him to come home, in a compartment in his vambrace. He has never played it. He has never deleted it.

A CULTURE DIVIDED

Before the wars, Mandalorian life was defined by three things: the clan, the Resol'nare, and the frontier.

The **Resol'nare** — the six core tenets of Mandalorian identity — required every Mandalorian to wear armor, speak Mando'a, defend their clan, raise their children as Mandalorians, contribute to the clan's welfare, and answer the call of Mandalore. These were not abstractions. They structured daily life the way religious law structures an observant community.

A Mandalorian farmer on **Dxun** woke before dawn, worked the kkanmur grain fields (a hardy Dxun cereal crop that grows in the moon's dense humidity) in beskar-composite work armor (functional, not ceremonial — the climate on Dxun required it), spoke Mando'a at home and Basic for trade, trained with weapons for an hour each evening, and taught their children to do the same. The rhythm was agricultural and martial at once.

Mandalorian society before the wars was not wealthy. The clans controlled resource-rich worlds in the Outer Rim, but their economy was extractive rather than industrial. They mined cortosis and beskar. They hunted. They raided when times were lean. They traded with whoever offered fair terms and fought whoever offered unfair ones.

Women and men held equivalent social status in most clans (warriors were warriors, farmers were farmers, and gender was less relevant than competence). The Mandalorian adoption tradition — *gai bal manda*, taking a child of any species into a clan — meant that Mandalorian demographics were more diverse than outsiders assumed. A Twi'lek raised Mandalorian was Mandalorian. A human born on Coruscant who never wore armor was not.

The Concordat split this culture along a fault line that was already present.

Concordat Mandalorians maintain their warrior culture, their armor, their training traditions, and their clan structures. They also answer to Republic administrative authority on matters of civilian governance, taxation, and interstellar law. A Concordat Mandalorian warrior trains with her clan, serves in a joint military unit with Republic regulars, answers to a Mandalorian chieftain for matters of honor and to a Republic officer for matters of strategy, and goes home to a settlement where the grain distribution is managed by a Republic bureaucrat instead of a Mandalorian quartermaster.

Some find this livable. The grain arrives on time. The settlements have medical facilities. The children learn in schools that teach both Mando'a and Basic. Veera Ordo's vision of a functioning hybrid society is becoming real in some places.

Others find it suffocating. The armor is the same, but the meaning has changed. A Mandalorian warrior serving the Concordat is an employee, not a free warrior. The Resol'nare says to answer Mandalore's call — but Mandalore answers to Malak, so whose call are you answering?

Neo-Mandalorian life is harder and freer. Canderous Ordo's Coalition operates as a nomadic military force: mobile bases, raiding fleets, and temporary settlements on uninhabited moons and asteroids. Resources are scarce. Discipline is maintained through combat challenges. The Resol'nare is observed with fierce orthodoxy because it's the only structure they have left.

A Neo-Mandalorian warrior wakes in a barracks carved into an asteroid, trains with whatever weapons are available, raids a supply convoy if the fleet commanders have identified a target, and spends the evening maintaining armor that is harder to repair each month without access to Mandalorian forges that the Concordat now controls.

Children born into the Coalition know nothing but this life. They are raised hard, trained young, and told that they are the true inheritors of Mandalorian tradition. Whether this is liberation or deprivation depends on who you ask.

Neo-Mandalorian Character Hooks

- A warrior who's watched the Coalition's resources shrink and wonders if honor can sustain a people
- A non-Mandalorian recruit who adopted the armor and the code because the Mandalorians were the only faction that treated strength as its own justification
- A child of Concordat Mandalorians who defected because the Concordat's version of Mandalorian culture felt like a costume

CHAPTER 11
THE JEDI ORDER

What they claim: The Force is in crisis. Using it carelessly accelerates the damage. The Jedi Order's duty is to study the crisis, preserve Jedi knowledge, and avoid actions that could make things worse. Neutrality in the Concordat political conflict is necessary because choosing a side would subordinate the Jedi's mission to a political agenda.

What they do: The Jedi Order tried to remain neutral in the Concordat's formation and failed on every front. The Council's position was coherent in theory: the Force was damaged, and using it in combat might accelerate the damage. The Jedi should focus on understanding the crisis, healing what could be healed, and avoiding actions that could make things worse. In practice, this meant watching the galaxy burn while debating methodology.

JEDI TRADITION

Before the Mandalorian Wars, the Jedi Order was not a military organization. It was a monastic educational institution with peacekeeping authority. Jedi served as diplomats, mediators, investigators, and when necessary, combatants — but they did not maintain standing military units, a chain of command, or a strategic doctrine.

The Order's internal organization followed three traditional paths:

Jedi Guardians specialized in lightsaber combat and direct action. They served as the Order's martial arm: bodyguards for diplomats, first responders to violent crises, and the closest thing the Order had to soldiers. Guardians were respected but not dominant. The Council historically preferred Consulars and Sentinels for leadership positions.

Jedi Consulars specialized in Force study, diplomacy, and negotiation. They managed the Order's relationships with the Republic, with planetary governments, and with non-Jedi Force traditions. Consulars filled most Council seats and dominated the Order's intellectual life.

Jedi Sentinels blended Force training with practical non-Force skills: intelligence gathering, technical expertise, medicine, and field survival. They operated in the spaces between Guardian muscle and Consular diplomacy, often working alone or in small teams in the Outer Rim.

The three paths were not rigid castes. A Jedi could train in multiple disciplines, and many did. But the paths shaped how the Order thought about itself: scholars and diplomats at the center, warriors at the perimeter, specialists in between.

MILITARIZATION

When Revan walked out of the Temple with four hundred Jedi, the Order's organizational assumptions collapsed overnight.

Revan did not build a monastic community with lightsabers. He built a military.

The Revanchist Military Structure (3959–3955 BBY)

Revan adopted Republic military ranks but overlaid them with Jedi operational roles:

Rank	Role
Field Marshal Revan	Supreme commander. Strategic direction, left execution to Malak and field commanders.
General Malak	Second in command. Operational authority over all ground and fleet combat.
Jedi Commanders	Jedi Knights commanding mixed units of Jedi and Republic regulars. ~40 at peak.
Jedi Captains	Mid-rank officers commanding company-level units or serving as fleet attachés.
Jedi Lieutenants	Junior officers, typically recent Padawans. High casualty rate. High burnout rate.
Jedi Specialists	Non-command roles: healers, intelligence analysts, battle meditation practitioners.
Republic Line Officers	Non-Jedi military officers serving alongside and under Jedi commanders.

The most controversial rank was Jedi Commander, because it placed Jedi in direct authority over non-Force-sensitive soldiers. Roughly forty Jedi held Commander rank at the Revanchist peak. Some adapted to military command. Others treated their troops as extensions of their own will, using the Force to coordinate movements in ways that were effective but dehumanizing to the soldiers involved.

How the Jedi Became Warlike Without a "Fall"

The Jedi who joined the Revanchists did not fall to the dark side. Most of them never touched Sith sorcery, never opened a holocron, never sought forbidden power. What they did was worse, in a sense, because it was rational.

They learned to treat the Force as a military asset.

A Jedi Guardian who uses the Force to enhance her reflexes in combat is using the Force as a personal tool. This is normal. This is what Guardians do.

A Jedi Commander who uses battle meditation to coordinate three hundred soldiers is using the Force as a command-and-control system. This is qualitatively different. The soldiers become extensions of the Commander's will. Their fear, their pain, their individual combat decisions are overridden by the Commander's Force-enhanced coordination. The soldiers survive at higher rates. They also stop being soldiers and become instruments.

A group of sixty Jedi who channel together to produce an Ashen strike are using the Force as a strategic weapon. They are not fighting. They are not defending. They are operating a weapons system that happens to be powered by their bodies and the Force. The distinction between this and Sith ritual warfare is intent, not effect.

> The Jedi who participated in the Ashen Campaigns did not fall. They militarized. They developed a professional competence with violence that is not the dark side but is not the Jedi way either. They follow orders. They calculate acceptable casualties. They speak in military jargon about Force operations the way a Republic artillery officer speaks about turbolaser barrages. They have not lost their connection to the light side of the Force. They have stopped thinking about the Force in terms of light and dark at all. It is a tool. You use it. You maintain it. You deploy it where it produces the best tactical result.